



SKYWAYS AIR SERVICES LIMITED

(TO BE LISTED ON THE MAIN BOARD OF BSE AND NSE)



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Our Company was incorporated in Delhi as “Skyways Air Services Private Limited” a private limited company under the Companies Act, 1956, pursuant to a certificate of incorporation dated **December 21, 1984** issued by Registrar of Companies, Delhi and Haryana. Thereafter, our Company was converted from a private limited company to a public limited company under the provisions of the Companies Act, 2013, pursuant to a resolution passed in the extraordinary general meeting of our Shareholders held on March 29, 2025. Accordingly, upon conversion the name of our Company was changed to “**Skyways Air Services Limited**” by deletion of the word ‘Private’. A fresh certificate of incorporation consequent upon conversion of our Company from private limited company to public limited company dated **May 05, 2025**, was issued by the Registrar of Companies, Delhi bearing Corporate Identification Number “**U74899DL1984PLC019666**”. For details of incorporation, change of name and registered office of our company, please refer to chapter titled “**History and Certain Corporate Matters**” beginning on page 305 of the Red Herring Prospectus dated August 11, 2026 read with Corrigendum dated August 12, 2026 (“RHP” or “Red Herring Prospectus”).

**Registered and Corporate Office:** RZ 128-129A, Mahipalpur Extension NH-8, New Delhi, Delhi, India, 110037; **Tel. No.:** +91 – 9910791501, **E-mail:** cs@skyways-group.com; **Website:** www.skyways-air.in

**Contact Person:** Mr. Hitesh Kumar, Company Secretary and Compliance Officer; **Corporate Identity Number:** U74899DL1984PLC019666

THE PROMOTERS OF OUR COMPANY ARE MR. YASHPAL SHARMA AND MR. TARUN SHARMA

INITIAL PUBLIC OFFER OF UP TO 4,22,31,600 EQUITY SHARES OF FACE VALUE OF ₹10/- EACH (“EQUITY SHARES”) OF OUR COMPANY FOR CASH AT A PRICE OF ₹ [●] PER EQUITY SHARE (INCLUDING A SHARE PREMIUM OF ₹ [●] PER EQUITY SHARE), AGGREGATING TO ₹ [●] LAKHS (“THE OFFER”) COMPRISES OF A FRESH ISSUE OF UP TO 2,88,98,300 EQUITY SHARES AGGREGATING TO ₹ [●] LAKHS (“FRESH ISSUE”) AND AN OFFER FOR SALE OF UP TO 1,33,33,300 EQUITY SHARES (“OFFERED SHARES”) AGGREGATING TO ₹ [●] LAKHS COMPRISING UP TO 71,20,690 EQUITY SHARES BY YASHPAL SHARMA AGGREGATING TO ₹ [●] LAKHS AND UP TO 24,60,000 EQUITY SHARES BY TARUN SHARMA AGGREGATING TO ₹ [●] LAKHS (COLLECTIVELY, “PROMOTER SELLING SHAREHOLDERS”) AND UP TO 18,66,000 EQUITY SHARES BY HIMANSHU CHHABRA AGGREGATING TO ₹ [●] LAKHS AND UP TO 18,86,610 EQUITY SHARES BY ROHIT SEHGAL AGGREGATING TO ₹ [●] LAKHS (COLLECTIVELY, “OTHER SELLING SHAREHOLDERS”), (THE “SELLING SHAREHOLDERS”), AND SUCH OFFER FOR SALE OF EQUITY SHARES BY THE SELLING SHAREHOLDERS, (THE “OFFER FOR SALE”). THE OFFER WILL CONSTITUTE [●] % OF THE POST OFFER PAID UP EQUITY SHARE CAPITAL OF OUR COMPANY. OUR COMPANY HAS UNDERTAKEN A PRE-IPO PLACEMENT OF 40,19,326 EQUITY SHARES OF FACE VALUE OF ₹ 10/- EACH AT A PRICE OF ₹ 120/- PER EQUITY SHARE AGGREGATING TO ₹ 4,823.19 LAKHS. THE SIZE OF THE FRESH ISSUE AS DISCLOSED IN THE DRAFT RED HERRING PROSPECTUS, AGGREGATING UP TO 3,29,17,700 EQUITY SHARES OF FACE VALUE OF ₹ 10/- EACH HAS BEEN REDUCED BY 40,19,326 EQUITY SHARES OF FACE VALUE OF ₹ 10/- EACH PURSUANT TO THE PRE-IPO PLACEMENT, SUBJECT TO COMPLIANCE WITH RULE 19(2)(B) OF THE SCRR, AND ACCORDINGLY, THE FRESH ISSUE IS FOR AN AGGREGATE OF UP TO 2,88,98,300 EQUITY SHARES OF FACE VALUE OF ₹ 10/- EACH. FURTHER, THE PRE-IPO PLACEMENT HAS NOT EXCEEDED 20% OF THE SIZE OF THE FRESH ISSUE.

OUR COMPANY HAS APPROPRIATELY INTIMATED THE SUBSCRIBERS TO THE PRE-IPO PLACEMENT THAT THERE IS NO GUARANTEE THAT OUR COMPANY MAY PROCEED WITH THE OFFER, OR THE OFFER MAY BE SUCCESSFUL AND WILL RESULT INTO LISTING OF THE EQUITY SHARES ON THE STOCK EXCHANGES, AND THE INVESTMENT IS BEING DONE SOLELY AT THE RISK OF THE INVESTOR.

| DETAILS OF OFFER FOR SALE, SELLING SHAREHOLDER AND THEIR WEIGHTED AVERAGE COST OF ACQUISITION |                              |                                                                                           |                                                        |
|-----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|------------------------------|-------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|--------------------------------------------------------|
| NAME OF SELLING SHAREHOLDER                                                                   | TYPE                         | NUMBER OF SHARES OFFERED                                                                  | WEIGHTED AVERAGE COST OF ACQUISITION PER EQUITY SHARE* |
| Yashpal Sharma                                                                                | Promoter Selling Shareholder | Up to 71,20,690 Equity Shares having face value of ₹ 10/- each aggregating to ₹ [●] Lakhs | NIL                                                    |
| Tarun Sharma                                                                                  | Promoter Selling Shareholder | Up to 24,60,000 Equity Shares having face value of ₹ 10/- each aggregating to ₹ [●] Lakhs | NIL                                                    |
| Himanshu Chhabra                                                                              | Other Selling Shareholder    | Up to 18,66,000 Equity Shares having face value of ₹ 10/- each aggregating to ₹ [●] Lakhs | NIL                                                    |
| Rohit Sehgal                                                                                  | Other Selling Shareholder    | Up to 18,86,610 Equity Shares having face value of ₹ 10/- each aggregating to ₹ [●] Lakhs | NIL                                                    |

\*On a fully diluted basis, as certified by S.K. Singla & Associates, Independent Chartered Accountants, by way of their certificate dated July 16, 2026. For further details, see “The Offer” on page 70 of the RHP.

PRICE BAND: ₹131/- TO ₹138/- PER EQUITY SHARE OF FACE VALUE OF ₹10 EACH.

THE FLOOR PRICE IS 13.10 TIMES OF THE FACE VALUE AND THE CAP PRICE IS 13.80 TIMES OF THE FACE VALUE

BID CAN BE MADE FOR A MINIMUM OF 100 EQUITY SHARES AND IN MULTIPLES OF 100 EQUITY SHARES THEREAFTER.

THE PRICE TO EARNINGS RATIO (“P/E”) BASED ON DILUTED EPS FOR FISCAL YEAR 2026 AT THE LOWER END OF THE PRICE BAND (i.e. FLOOR PRICE ₹ 131/-)

IS 36.80 TIMES AND AT THE UPPER END OF THE PRICE BAND (i.e. CAP PRICE ₹ 138/-) IS 38.76 TIMES AS COMPARED TO THE AVERAGE INDUSTRY PEER GROUP P/E RATIO OF 491 TIMES.

WEIGHTED AVERAGE RETURN ON NET WORTH FOR LAST THREE FISCAL YEARS IS 14.83%.

The details of the Fresh Issue and the post Offer market capitalization of the Company, each at the Floor Price and the Cap Price, are given below:

| Particulars                      | OFFER SIZE AND MARKET CAPITALIZATION                  |                           |                                                       |                           |
|----------------------------------|-------------------------------------------------------|---------------------------|-------------------------------------------------------|---------------------------|
|                                  | At Floor Price of ₹ 131/- per Equity Shares           |                           | At Cap Price of ₹ 138/- per Equity Shares             |                           |
|                                  | Up to No. of Equity Shares of face value of ₹ 10 each | Up to Amount (₹ in Lakhs) | Up to No. of Equity Shares of face value of ₹ 10 each | Up to Amount (₹ in Lakhs) |
| Fresh Issue                      | 2,88,98,300                                           | 37,856.77                 | 2,88,98,300                                           | 39,879.65                 |
| Offer for Sale                   | 1,33,33,300                                           | 17,466.62                 | 1,33,33,300                                           | 18,399.95                 |
| Total Offer Size                 | 4,22,31,600                                           | 55,323.40                 | 4,22,31,600                                           | 58,279.61                 |
| Post Offer Market Capitalisation | 14,53,43,544                                          | 1,90,400.04               | 14,53,43,544                                          | 2,00,574.09               |

OFFER PROGRAMME

BID / OFFER OPENS TODAY

BID / OFFER CLOSSES ON: THURSDAY, AUGUST 27, 2026\*\*

\*Our Company, in consultation with the BRLMs may consider participation by Anchor Investors in accordance with the SEBI ICDR Regulations. The Anchor Investor Bidding Date shall be one Working Day prior to the Bid/Offer Opening Date.

\*\* UPI mandate end time and date shall be at 5:00 p.m. on the Bid/Offer Closing Date.

Our Company is a multimodal logistics group having a dominant position in Indian air freight cargo market. The company is also engaged in ocean cargo, tech driven express cargo services, warehousing, trucking, customer Broking and other value added services and provide end to end services to their customers. We are consistently ranked No. 1 "Air Freight Forwarder" in terms of AWBs generation by World ACD for last four calendar years 2025, 2024, 2023 and 2022 (Source: World ACD Market Data).

THE OFFER IS BEING MADE THROUGH THE BOOK BUILDING PROCESS IN ACCORDANCE WITH REGULATION 6(1) OF THE SEBI ICDR REGULATIONS, 2018.

THE EQUITY SHARES OF THE COMPANY WILL GET LISTED ON THE MAIN BOARD OF BSE LIMITED AND NATIONAL STOCK EXCHANGE OF INDIA LIMITED.

BSE LIMITED SHALL BE THE DESIGNATED STOCK EXCHANGE.

QIB PORTION: NOT MORE THAN 50% OF THE NET OFFER | NON-INSTITUTIONAL PORTION: NOT LESS THAN 15% OF THE NET OFFER | RETAIL INDIVIDUAL PORTION: NOT LESS THAN 35% OF THE NET OFFER

IN MAKING AN INVESTMENT DECISION, POTENTIAL INVESTORS MUST ONLY RELY ON THE INFORMATION INCLUDED IN THE RED HERRING PROSPECTUS AND THE TERMS OF THE OFFER, INCLUDING THE RISKS INVOLVED AND NOT RELY ON ANY OTHER EXTERNAL SOURCES OF INFORMATION ABOUT THE OFFER AVAILABLE IN ANY MANNER. IN RELATION TO PRICE BAND, POTENTIAL INVESTORS SHOULD ONLY REFER TO THIS PRICE BAND ADVERTISEMENT FOR THE OFFER AND SHOULD NOT RELY ON ANY MEDIA ARTICLES/ REPORTS IN RELATION TO THE VALUATION OF OUR COMPANY AS THESE ARE NOT ENDORSED, PUBLISHED OR CONFIRMED EITHER BY OUR COMPANY OR THE BRLMs.

IN ACCORDANCE WITH THE RECOMMENDATION OF THE COMMITTEE OF INDEPENDENT DIRECTORS OF OUR COMPANY, PURSUANT TO THEIR RESOLUTION DATED JUNE 26, 2026, THAT THE PRICE BAND IS JUSTIFIED VIS-AVIS THE LAST ROUND OF FUND RAISING GIVING QUANTITATIVE FACTORS/ KPIS. FOR DETAILS, SEE “BASIS FOR OFFER PRICE- QUANTITATIVE FACTORS” ON PAGE 131-139 OF THE RHP.

RISK TO INVESTORS

For details refer to section titled “Risk Factors” beginning on page 29 of the RHP

1. Dependency on Third-Party Carriers for Cargo Transportation Risk:

Our business is 100% dependent on the availability, pricing and service quality of third-party carriers, as we do not operate our own aircraft or shipping lines. Consequently, our business is 100% dependent on the availability, pricing, and service quality of such carriers, particularly for the movement of time-sensitive or high-value shipments. The details of the major revenue generated segments are as follows:

| Particulars            | For the year ended on March 31, 2026 |                              | For the year ended on March 31, 2025 |                              | For the year ended on March 31, 2024 |                              |
|------------------------|--------------------------------------|------------------------------|--------------------------------------|------------------------------|--------------------------------------|------------------------------|
|                        | Amount (in Lakhs)                    | % of revenue from operations | Amount (in Lakhs)                    | % of revenue from operations | Amount (in Lakhs)                    | % of revenue from operations |
| Air Cargo Services     | 2,16,639.87                          | 77.02%                       | 1,64,076.56                          | 72.99%                       | 1,02,099.98                          | 79.20%                       |
| Ocean Cargo Services   | 42,260.32                            | 15.02%                       | 39,450.06                            | 17.55%                       | 16,495.76                            | 12.80%                       |
| Express Cargo & Parcel | 16,277.96                            | 5.79%                        | 14,123.41                            | 6.28%                        | 5,882.79                             | 4.56%                        |
| Total                  | 2,75,178.15                          | 97.83%                       | 2,17,650.03                          | 96.82%                       | 1,24,478.53                          | 96.56%                       |

Pursuant to certificate dated July 11, 2026, received from Independent Chartered Accountant, M/S S.K. Singla & Associates, Chartered Accountants

The air cargo, ocean cargo and express cargo and parcel services together constituted 97.83%, 96.82% and 96.56% for the fiscal years ended on March 31, 2026, 2025 and 2024 respectively of our revenue from operations, all of which are directly dependent on carrier capacity and cost. Any disruption in the availability of carriers, or our inability to secure cargo space on commercially viable terms, may adversely affect our business, results of operations and financial condition.

2. Supplier Concentration Risk:

We rely on limited number of suppliers and procure 36.01%, 31.20% and 38.29% of our cost of service for the Fiscal Years ended on March 31, 2026, 2025 and 2024 respectively from our Top 5 suppliers and 49.00%, 46.93% and 54.31% of our cost of service from our top 10 suppliers for the Fiscal Years ended on March 31, 2026, 2025 and 2024 respectively. Any failure to maintain good business relations and retain the suppliers in the long-run will adversely impact our business and result of operations. The contribution to the cost of service of our Company from our top ten and top five large suppliers is as set out below:

| Particulars      | For the year ended on March 31, |                      |                   |                      |                   |                      |
|------------------|---------------------------------|----------------------|-------------------|----------------------|-------------------|----------------------|
|                  | 2026                            |                      | 2025              |                      | 2024              |                      |
|                  | Amount (in Lakhs)               | % of cost of service | Amount (in Lakhs) | % of cost of service | Amount (in Lakhs) | % of cost of service |
| Top 5 Suppliers  | 90,314.98                       | 36.01%               | 62,915.91         | 31.20%               | 43,536.14         | 38.29%               |
| Top 10 Suppliers | 1,22,866.81                     | 49.00%               | 94,658.45         | 46.93%               | 61,761.31         | 54.31%               |

Pursuant to certificate dated July 16, 2026, received from Independent Chartered Accountant, M/s S.K. Singla & Associates, Chartered Accountants

3. Geographical Concentration Risk:

Our revenue is heavily concentrated in the Asia region contributing 85.51%, 83.07% and 86.39% of our total revenue for the fiscal years ended on March 31, 2026, 2025 and 2024 respectively, exposing us to adverse developments including economic downturns, political instability or natural disasters in this region. Our inability to expand into other regions, or to compete effectively with local players in new markets, could adversely affect our business prospects, financial condition and results of operations.

| Continents | For the year ended on March 31 |                    |                          |                    |                          |                    |
|------------|--------------------------------|--------------------|--------------------------|--------------------|--------------------------|--------------------|
|            | 2026                           |                    | 2025                     |                    | 2024                     |                    |
|            | Total Revenue (in Lakhs)       | % of total revenue | Total Revenue (in Lakhs) | % of total revenue | Total Revenue (in Lakhs) | % of total revenue |
| Asia       | 2,40,515.48                    | 85.51%             | 1,86,735.83              | 83.07%             | 1,11,364.62              | 86.39%             |
| Europe     | 16,663.93                      | 5.92%              | 12,678.34                | 5.64%              | 5,104.68                 | 3.96%              |

|               |             |         |             |         |             |         |
|---------------|-------------|---------|-------------|---------|-------------|---------|
| North America | 16,460.55   | 5.85%   | 15,979.60   | 7.11%   | 7,020.37    | 5.45%   |
| South America | 7,390.08    | 2.63%   | 9,153.79    | 4.07%   | 4,890.68    | 3.79%   |
| Oceania       | 152.69      | 0.05%   | 215.75      | 0.10%   | 474.02      | 0.37%   |
| Africa        | 107.16      | 0.04%   | 19.18       | 0.01%   | 56.64       | 0.04%   |
| Total Revenue | 2,81,289.89 | 100.00% | 2,24,782.49 | 100.00% | 1,28,911.01 | 100.00% |

Pursuant to certificate dated July 22, 2026, received from Independent Chartered Accountant, M/S S.K. Singla & Associates, Chartered Accountants.

4. Criminal Proceedings Relating to Alleged Fraud and Corruption:

An FIR has been filed against our Company, our Material Subsidiary, Brace Port Logistics Limited, and seven other parties alleging criminal breach of trust, cheating, fraud, corruption and related offences in connection with business conducted by certain subsidiaries with a UK-based customer. Although our Company had no direct transactions with the complainant, it has been dragged in the case due to its relationship with the Material Subsidiary. Any adverse outcome of these proceedings, including prosecution or regulatory action, could materially and adversely affect the reputation, business, financial condition and results of operations of our Company and the Material Subsidiary. Our Company and the concerned subsidiaries are contesting the allegations and pursuing appropriate legal remedies.

5. Revenue Growth Sustainability Risk:

Our revenue from operations has grown significantly from ₹ 1,28,911.01 lakhs in Fiscal 2024 to ₹ 2,81,289.89 lakhs in Fiscal 2026, representing a CAGR of 47.72% over the period, primarily driven by strong growth in our air freight forwarding business, higher air cargo volumes, expansion of our customer base and increased airline partnerships. There can be no assurance that we will be able to sustain this rate of growth in future. Any slowdown in the air freight forwarding industry, reduction in cargo volumes, loss of key customers or airline relationships, increased competition, adverse changes in freight rates or capacity constraints, or inability to effectively execute our growth strategy could adversely affect our revenue growth, profitability, financial condition and results of operations.

6. High Working Capital Requirements Risk:

Our business operations involve substantial working capital requirements, primarily to finance trade receivables and other current assets. These requirements have historically been funded largely through borrowings. Our working capital gap is majorly financed through working capital loans to the tune of 86.23%, 100.00% and 82.62% respectively for the fiscal years ended on March 31, 2026, 2025 and 2024. Our company's working capital gap grew from ₹ 24,265.23 Lakhs in Fiscal 2024 to ₹ 31,107.09 Lakhs in Fiscal 2026. Any inability to maintain adequate cash flows or obtain timely funding to meet our working capital and debt obligations could materially and adversely affect our financial condition and results of operations. The details of the working capital gap is as follows:

| Particulars                      | For the year ended on March 31, |           |           |
|----------------------------------|---------------------------------|-----------|-----------|
|                                  | 2026                            | 2025      | 2024      |
| Working Capital Gap (₹ in Lakhs) | 31,107.09                       | 23,705.89 | 24,265.23 |
| % Funded through Borrowings      | 86.23%                          | 100.00%   | 82.62%    |
| Debt-to-Equity Ratio (times)     | 1.26                            | 1.42      | 1.92      |

7. Contingent Liabilities and Commitments Risk:

As of March 31, 2026, our contingent liabilities and commitments aggregated ₹ 28,908.02 Lakhs, tantamounting to 86.90% of our total net worth of ₹ 33,264.21 Lakhs as of that date. If any of these were to materialise, our financial position, profitability and cash flows could be adversely affected.

8. Litigation and Legal Proceedings Risk:

Our Company, Subsidiaries, Promoters, Directors and Senior Managerial Personnel are involved in certain outstanding legal and regulatory proceedings, including criminal, tax and civil litigation. The proceedings include 1 criminal, 2 statutory or regulatory proceedings and 9 tax cases against the Company involving an aggregate amount of ₹3,752.49 lakhs, 2 criminal, 2 statutory or regulatory proceedings and 29 tax cases against Subsidiaries involving ₹640.72 lakhs, and 10 criminal and 2 civil proceedings initiated by the Company and its Subsidiaries involving ₹1,588.59 lakhs. Any adverse decision in such proceedings may have a material adverse effect on our business, financial condition, cash flows and results of operations.

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9. Regulatory Compliances Risk:

Our business is dependent on obtaining, renewing and maintaining various statutory licences, registrations, permits and approvals. While we have obtained all material approvals required for our operations, certain approvals remain pending, including a Fire NOC for our Delhi warehouse. Any delay or failure in obtaining, renewing or complying with the conditions of such approvals may result in penalties, regulatory action, operational restrictions or legal proceedings, which could materially and adversely affect our business, financial condition, cash flows and results of operations.

10. Significant Dependence on Air Cargo Business Risk:

Our business is significantly dependent on our air freight forwarding operations, which contributed a substantial portion of our operating revenue. We handled 83,923.81 tonnes of air cargo and generated revenue of ₹ 2,16,639.87 lakhs which amounts to 77.02% of our revenue from operations from air freight services during Fiscal 2026. Although we had business relationships with 56 airlines during Fiscal 2026, including performance-based arrangements with certain leading international airlines, there can be no assurance that such relationships will continue on existing terms or at all. Any disruption in our air freight forwarding business or inability to maintain cargo volumes, airline relationships or service quality could materially and adversely affect our business, financial condition, cash flows and results of operations.

11. Risk of Inability to Fully Utilise Contracted Container Capacity

Our ocean freight forwarding business requires us to purchase container space from shipping lines in advance at fixed rates. If we are unable to utilise or sell the contracted container capacity, we may be unable to recover the associated costs, which could adversely affect our profitability, financial condition and results of operations. Although we have not experienced such an event during the last three Fiscals, there can be no assurance that it will not occur in the future.

12. Pre-IPO Pricing Risk:

The bidders in the IPO face the risk of applying in the IPO at a price band of ₹ 131/- to ₹ 138/- which is higher than ₹ 120/- at which the shares were allotted in the Pre-IPO.

13. The Price to Earnings ratio based on diluted EPS for fiscal year ended 2026 for the Company at the upper end of the Price Band is 38.76 times and at the lower end of the Price Band is 36.80 times.

14. The average cost of acquisition of Equity Shares by Promoters and selling shareholders is ₹ 0.0005 for Mr. Yashpal Sharma (Promoter and selling shareholder) and NIL for Mr. Tarun Sharma (Promoter and selling shareholder), Mr. Himanshu Chhabra (Other Selling shareholder) and Mr. Rohit Sehgal (Other Selling shareholder) and the Offer Price at upper end of the Price Band is ₹ 138/- per Equity Share.
15. Weighted Average Return on Net Worth for Fiscals 2026, 2025 and 2024 is 14.83%.
16. The three BRLMs associated with the Offer have handled Eight public issues in the past three Fiscal Years out of which One Issue has closed below the Issue Price on Listing Date.

| Name of the BRLM                   | Total Public Issues | Issue Closed below the Issue Price on Listing Date |
|------------------------------------|---------------------|----------------------------------------------------|
| Holani Consultants Private Limited | 7                   | NIL                                                |
| Shannon Advisors Private Limited   | 1                   | 1                                                  |
| Dolat Finserv Private Limited      | -                   |                                                    |
| <b>TOTAL</b>                       | <b>8</b>            | <b>1</b>                                           |

17. Weighted average cost of acquisition of all shares transacted in the three years, 18 months and one year preceding the date of the Red Herring Prospectus:

| Period               | Weighted average cost of acquisition (in ₹) | Cap Price is 'x' times the weighted average cost of acquisition | Range of acquisition price: lowest price – highest price (in ₹) |
|----------------------|---------------------------------------------|-----------------------------------------------------------------|-----------------------------------------------------------------|
| Last one year        | Nil                                         | Nil                                                             | Nil                                                             |
| Last eighteen months | 115.82/-                                    | 1.19                                                            | 94/- to 120/-                                                   |
| Last three years     | 102.65/-                                    | 1.34                                                            | 94/- to 120/-                                                   |

Pursuant to certificate dated August 08, 2026, received from Independent Chartered Accountant, M/S S.K. Singla & associates, Chartered Accountants

BASIS FOR OFFER PRICE

The “Basis for Offer Price ” on page 131 of the RHP has been updated with the above Price Band. Please refer to the website of the BRLMs: [www.holaniconsultants.co.in](http://www.holaniconsultants.co.in), [www.shannon.co.in](http://www.shannon.co.in) and [www.dolatfinserv.com](http://www.dolatfinserv.com) for the “Basis for Offer Price ” updated for the above Price Band. (You may scan the QR code for accessing the website of Holani Consultants Private Limited)

AN INDICATIVE TIMETABLE IN RESPECT OF THE OFFER IS SET OUT BELOW:

|                                                                                               |                                                                      |                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                           |                                         |
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| <b>Submission of Bids (other than Bids from Anchor Investors):</b>                            |                                                                      | Initiation of refunds (if any, for Anchor Investors)/ unblocking of funds from ASBA Account*                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                              | On or about Monday, August 31, 2026     |
| <b>Bid/Offer Period (except the Bid/Offer Closing Date)</b>                                   |                                                                      | Credit of Equity Shares to depository accounts of Allottees                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                               | On or about Monday, August 31, 2026     |
| Submission and revision in Bids                                                               | Only between 10.00 a.m. and 5.00 p.m. (Indian Standard Time (“IST”)) | Commencement of trading of the Equity Shares on the Stock Exchanges                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                       | On or about Tuesday, September 01, 2026 |
| <b>Bid/Offer Closing Date*</b>                                                                |                                                                      | <sup>(1)</sup> Our Company and the Selling Shareholders in consultation with the BRLMs, may consider participation by Anchor Investors. The Anchor Investor Bid/Offer Period shall be one Working Day prior to the Bid/Offer Opening Date in accordance with the SEBI/ICDR Regulations.                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                   |                                         |
| Submission and revision in Bids                                                               | Only between 10.00 a.m. and 3.00 p.m. IST                            | <sup>(2)</sup> Our Company and the Selling Shareholders in consultation with the BRLMs may, consider closing the Bid/Offer Period for QIBs one day prior to the Bid/Offer Closing Date in accordance with the SEBI/ICDR Regulations                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                       |                                         |
| <sup>(3)</sup> UPI mandate end time and date shall be at 5.00 pm on Thursday, August 27, 2026 |                                                                      | <sup>(3)</sup> UPI mandate end time and date shall be at 5.00 pm on Thursday, August 27, 2026.                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                            |                                         |
| <b>On the Bid/ Offer Closing Date, the Bids shall be uploaded until:</b>                      |                                                                      | <sup>(4)</sup> In case of (i) any delay in unblocking of amounts in the ASBAAccounts (including amounts blocked through the UPI Mechanism) for cancelled/ withdrawn/ deleted ASBA Forms, the Bidder shall be compensated at a uniform rate of ₹ 100 per day or 15% per annum of the Bid Amount, whichever is higher from the date on which the request for cancellation/ withdrawal/ deletion is placed in Stock Exchanges bidding platform until the date on which the amounts are unblocked; (ii) any blocking of multiple amounts for the same ASBA Form (for amounts blocked through the UPI Mechanism), the Bidder shall be compensated at a uniform rate ₹ 100 per day or 15% per annum of the total cumulative blocked amount except the original application amount, whichever is higher from the date on which such multiple amounts were blocked till the date of actual unblock; (iii) any blocking of amounts more than the Bid Amount, the Bidder shall be compensated at a uniform rate of ₹ 100 per day or 15% per annum of the difference in amount, whichever is higher from the date on which such excess amounts were blocked till the date of actual unblock; (iv) any delay in unblocking of non-allotted/ partially allotted Bids, exceeding two Working Days from the Bid/ Offer Closing Date, the Bidder shall be compensated at a uniform rate of ₹100 per day or 15% per annum of the Bid Amount, whichever is higher for the entire duration of delay exceeding two Working Days from the Bid/ Offer Closing Date by the SCSB responsible for causing such delay in unblocking. The post Offer BRLMs shall be liable for compensating the Bidder at a uniform rate of ₹100 per day or 15% per annum of the Bid Amount, whichever is higher from the date of receipt of the Investor grievance until the date on which the blocked amounts are unblocked. The Bidder shall be compensated in the manner specified in the SEBI circular no. SEBI/HO/CFD/DIL1/CIR/P/2021/47 dated March 31, 2021 and SEBI circular no. SEBI/HO/CFD/DIL2/CIR/P/2021/2480/1/M dated March 16, 2021, as amended pursuant to SEBI circular no. SEBI/HO/CFD/DIL2/P/CIR/2021/570 dated June 2, 2021, as amended pursuant to SEBI circular no. SEBI/HO/CFD/DIL2/CIR/P/2022/51 dated April 20, 2022 which for the avoidance of doubt, shall be deemed to be incorporated in the deemed agreement of the Company with the SCSBs, to the extent applicable. |                                         |
| <b>Bid/ Offer Programme</b>                                                                   |                                                                      |                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                           |                                         |
| <b>Event</b>                                                                                  | <b>Indicative Date</b>                                               |                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                           |                                         |
| Anchor Investor Bid/ Offer Period Opens and Closes on                                         | Friday, August 21, 2026                                              |                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                           |                                         |
| Bid/Offer Opens on <sup>(1)</sup>                                                             | Monday, August 24, 2026                                              |                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                           |                                         |
| Bid/Offer Closes on <sup>(2)(3)</sup>                                                         | Thursday, August 27, 2026                                            |                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                           |                                         |
| Finalisation of Basis of Allotment with the Designated Stock Exchange                         |                                                                      | On or about Friday, August 28, 2026                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                       |                                         |

ASBA \*

Simple, Safe, Smart way of Application!!!

\*Applications Supported by Blocked Amount (“ASBA”) is a better way of applying to offers by simply blocking the fund in the bank account.

For further details, check section on ASBA.

Mandatory in public issues.

No cheque will be accepted.

UPI

UNIFIED PAYMENTS INTERFACE

UPI-Now available in ASBA for Retail Individual Investors and Non Institutional Investor applying in public issues where the application amount is up to ₹ 5,00,000, applying through Registered Brokers, Syndicate, CDPs & RTAs. UPI Bidders also have the option to submit the application directly to the ASBA Bank (SCSBs) or to use the facility of linked online trading, demat and bank account. Investors are required to ensure that the bank account used for bidding is linked to their PAN. Bidders must ensure that their PAN is linked with Aadhaar and are in compliance with Central Board of Direct Taxes (“CBDT”) notification dated February 13, 2020 issued by the CBDT and the subsequent press releases, including press release dated June 25, 2021 read with press release dated September 17, 2021, and CBDT circular no. 7 of 2022 dated March 30, 2022, read with press release dated March 28, 2023, and any subsequent press release in this regard.

ASBA has to be availed by all the investors except Anchor Investors. UPI may be availed by (i) Retail Individual Investors in the Retail Category; (ii) Non-Institutional Investors with an application size of up to ₹ 5,00,000 in the Non-Institutional Portion. For more details “on the ASBA and UPI process, please refer to the details given in the Bid Cum Application Form and Abridged Prospectus and also please refer to the section “Offer Procedure” on page 578 of the RHP. The process is also available on the website of Association of Investment Bankers of India (“AIBI”) and Stock Exchanges and in the General Information Document. The Bid Cum Application Form and the Abridged Prospectus can be downloaded from the websites of the Stock Exchanges and can be obtained from the list of banks that is displayed on the website of SEBI at [www.sebi.gov.in/sebiweb/other/OtherAction.do?doRecognisedFpi=yes&intmid=35](http://www.sebi.gov.in/sebiweb/other/OtherAction.do?doRecognisedFpi=yes&intmid=35) and <https://www.sebi.gov.in/sebiweb/other/OtherAction.do?doRecognisedFpi=yes&intmid=43>, respectively as updated from time to time. For the list of UPI apps and banks live on IPO, please refer to the link: [www.sebi.gov.in](http://www.sebi.gov.in). UPI Bidders Bidding using the UPI Mechanism may apply through the SCSBs and mobile applications whose names appear on the website of SEBI, as updated from time to time. Axis Bank Limited and HDFC Bank Limited have been appointed as the Sponsor Banks for the Offer, in accordance with the requirements of SEBI circular dated November 1, 2018 as amended. For offer related queries, please contact the BRLMs on their respective email IDs as mentioned below. For UPI related queries, investors can contact NPCI at the toll free number: 18001201740 and mail id: [ipo.upi@npci.org.in](mailto:ipo.upi@npci.org.in).

In case of any revision in the Price Band, the Bid / Offer Period will be extended by at least three additional Working Days after such revision in the Price Band, subject to the Bid / Offer Period not exceeding 10 working days, in cases of force majeure, banking strike or similar circumstances, our Company in consultation with the BRLMs, for reasons to be recorded in writing, may extend the Bid / Offer Period for a minimum of three Working Days, subject to the Bid / Offer Period not exceeding 10 working days, any revision in the Price Band and the revised Bid / Offer Period, if applicable, shall be widely disseminated by notification to the Stock Exchanges, by issuing a public notice, and also by indicating the change on the respective websites of the BRLMs and at the terminals of the Syndicate Members and by intimation to the Designated Intermediaries and the Sponsor Bank. The Offer is being made through the Book Building Process, in terms of Rule 19(2)(b)(i) of the Securities Contracts (Regulation) Rules, 1957, as amended (“SCRR”) read with Regulation 31 of the Securities and Exchange Board of India (Issue of Capital and Disclosure Requirements) Regulations, 2018, as amended (SEBI ICDR Regulations) and in compliance with Regulation 61(1) of the SEBI ICDR Regulations wherein not more than 50% of the Net Offer shall be available for allocation on a proportionate basis to Qualified Institutional Buyers (“QIBs and such portion, the “QIB Portion”), provided that our Company in consultation with the BRLMs, may allocate up to 60% of the QIB Portion to Anchor Investors on a discretionary basis (“Anchor Investor Portion”), out of which Up to 40% of the Anchor Investor Portion shall be reserved in the following manner (i) 33.33% of the Anchor Investor Portion shall be reserved for domestic Mutual Funds; and (ii) 6.67% of the Anchor Investor Portion shall be reserved for Life Insurance Companies and Pension Funds, subject to valid Bids being received from domestic Mutual Funds, Life Insurance Companies and Pension Funds, as applicable, at or above the Anchor Investor Allocation Price (“Anchor Investor Allocation Price”), in accordance with the SEBI ICDR Regulations. In the event of under-subscription, or non-allocation in the Anchor Investor Portion, the balance Equity Shares shall be added to the QIB Portion (excluding the Anchor Investor Portion) (“Net QIB Portion”). Further, 5% of the Net QIB Portion shall be available for allocation on a proportionate basis to Mutual Funds only, and the remainder of the Net QIB Portion shall be available for allocation on a proportionate basis to all QIB Bidders, including Mutual Funds, subject to valid Bids being received from them at or above the Offer Price. However, if the aggregate demand from Mutual Funds is less than 5% of the Net QIB Portion, the balance Equity Shares available for allocation in the Mutual Fund Portion will be added to the remaining Net QIB Portion for proportionate allocation to QIBs. Further, not less than 15% of the Net Offer shall be available for allocation to Non-Institutional Bidders and not less than 35% of the Net Offer shall be available for allocation to Retail Individual Bidders in accordance with the SEBI ICDR Regulations, subject to valid Bids being received from them at or above the Offer Price. The Equity Shares available for allocation to Non-Institutional Bidders under the Non-Institutional Portion, shall be subject to the following: (i) one-third of the portion available to Non-Institutional Bidders shall be reserved for applicants with an application size of more than ₹ 2.00 Lakhs and up to ₹ 10.00 Lakhs, and (ii) two-third of the portion available to Non-Institutional Bidders shall be reserved for applicants with an application size of more than ₹ 10.00 Lakhs, provided that the unsubscribed portion in either of the aforementioned subcategories may be allocated to applicants in the other sub-category of Non-Institutional Bidders. All potential Bidders (except Anchor Investors) are mandatorily required to utilise the Application Supported by Blocked Amount (“ASBA”) process by providing details of their respective ASBA accounts and UPI ID in case of UPI Bidders using the UPI Mechanism, as applicable, pursuant to which their corresponding Bid Amount will be blocked by the Self Certified Syndicate Banks (“SCSBs”) or by the Sponsor Banks under the UPI Mechanism, as the case may be, to the extent of the respective Bid Amounts. Anchor Investors are not permitted to participate in the Offer through the ASBA Process. For details, see “Offer Procedure” beginning on page 578. of the RHP.

Bidders/Applicants should ensure that DP ID, PAN and the Client ID and UPI ID (for UPI Bidders bidding through UPI Mechanism) are correctly filled in the Bid cum Application Form. The DP ID, PAN and Client ID provided in the Bid cum Application Form should match with the DP ID, PAN, Client ID and UPI ID available (for UPI Bidders bidding through the UPI Mechanism) in the Depository database, otherwise, the Bid cum Application Form is liable to be rejected. Bidders/Applicants should ensure that the beneficiary account provided in the Bid cum Application Form is active. Bidders/Applicants should note that on the basis of the PAN, DP ID, Client ID and UPI ID (for UPI Bidders bidding through the UPI mechanism) as provided in the Bid cum Application Form, the Bidder/Applicant may be deemed to have authorized the Depositories to provide to the Registrar to the offer, any requested Demographic Details of the Bidder/Applicant as available on the records of the depositories. These Demographic Details may be used, among other things, for giving Allotment Advice or unblocking of ASBA Account or for other correspondence(s) related to the Offer. Bidders/Applicants are advised to update any changes to their Demographic Details as available in the records of the

Depository Participant to ensure accuracy of records. Any delay resulting from failure to update the Demographic Details would be at the Bidders/Applicants' sole risk.

Investors must ensure that their PAN is linked with Aadhaar and are in compliance with the notification issued by CBDT notification dated February 13, 2020 and read with press releases dated June 25, 2021, September 17, 2021 and March 28, 2023 and any subsequent press releases in this regard.

Contents of the Memorandum of Association of our Company as regards its objects: For information on the main objects of our Company, please see “History and Certain Corporate Matters ” on page 305 of the RHP. The Memorandum of Association of our Company is a material document for inspection in relation to the offer. For further details, see “Material Contracts and Documents for Inspection” on page 623 of the RHP.

Liability of the members of our Company: Limited by shares.

Amount of share capital of our Company and capital structure: As on the date of the RHP, the authorised share capital of our Company is ₹ 1,62,00,00,000 divided into 16,20,00,000 Equity Shares of face value of ₹10/- each. The issued, subscribed and paid-up Equity share capital of our Company is ₹ 1,16,44,52,440 divided into 11,64,45,244 Equity Shares of face value of ₹ 10 each. For more details of the capital structure of the Company, see “Capital Structure” on page 89 of the RHP

Names of the initial signatories to the Memorandum of Association of the Company and the Number of Equity Shares Subscribed by them: The initial signatories to the Memorandum of Association of the Company and the number of Equity Shares subscribed by each of them are: Allotment of 1 equity share each to Mr. Sudarshan Lal Sharma and Manohar Lal Sharma of face value of ₹100 each. For more details of the share capital history of our Company please see “Capital Structure” on page 89 of the RHP.

Listing: The Equity Shares to be Allotted through the Red Herring Prospectus are proposed to be listed on the Stock Exchanges. Our Company has received 'in-principle' approvals from BSE and NSE for the listing of the Equity Shares pursuant to their letters dated September 12, 2025, and September 12, 2025, respectively. For the purposes of the Offer, the Designated Stock Exchange shall be BSE Limited. A signed copy of the Red Herring Prospectus and the Prospectus shall be filed with RoC in accordance with Sections 26(4) and 32 of the Companies Act, 2013. For details of the material contracts and documents available for inspection from the date of the Red Herring Prospectus up to the Bid/ Offer Closing Date, see “Material Contracts and Documents for Inspection” beginning on page 623 of the RHP.

Disclaimer Clause of Securities and Exchange Board of India (“SEBI”): SEBI only gives its observations on the draft offer documents and this does not constitute approval of either the Offer or the specified securities stated in the Offer Documents. The investors are advised to refer to page 552 of the RHP for the full text of the disclaimer clause of SEBI.

Disclaimer Clause of BSE (the Designated Stock Exchange): It is to be distinctly understood that the permission given by BSE Limited should not in any way be deemed or construed that the Red Herring Prospectus has been cleared or approved by BSE Limited nor does it certify the correctness or completeness of any of the contents of the Red Herring Prospectus. The investors are advised to refer to the page 552 of the Red Herring Prospectus for the full text of the disclaimer clause of BSE.

Disclaimer Clause of NSE: It is to be distinctly understood that the permission given by NSE should not in any way be deemed or construed that the Offer Document has been cleared or approved by NSE nor does it certify the correctness or completeness of any of the contents of the Offer Document. The investors are advised to refer to page 553 of the RHP for the full text of the disclaimer clause of NSE.

General Risks: Investments in equity and equity-related securities involve a degree of risk and investors should not invest any funds in the Offer unless they can afford to take the risk of losing their entire investment. Investors are advised to read the risk factors carefully before taking an investment decision in the Offer. For taking an investment decision, investors must rely on their own examination of our Company and the Offer, including the risks involved. The Equity Shares in the Offer have not been recommended or approved by the Securities and Exchange Board of India (“SEBI”), nor does SEBI guarantee the accuracy or adequacy of the contents of this Red Herring Prospectus. Specific attention of the investors is invited to “Risk Factors” beginning on page 29 of the RHP.

| BOOK RUNNING LEAD MANAGERS TO THE OFFER                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                           |                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                 |                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                      |                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                           | REGISTRAR TO THE OFFER                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                    | COMPANY SECRETARY AND COMPLIANCE OFFICER |
|---------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|-----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|---------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|---------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|------------------------------------------|
| <br><b>HOLANI CONSULTANTS PRIVATE LIMITED</b><br>401 – 405 & 416 – 418, 4th Floor, Soni Paris Point, Jai Singh Highway, Bani Park, Jaipur – 302016<br>Tel.: +91 141 – 2203996<br>Website: <a href="http://www.holaniconsultants.co.in">www.holaniconsultants.co.in</a><br>Email: <a href="mailto:ipo@holaniconsultants.co.in">ipo@holaniconsultants.co.in</a><br>Investor Grievance ID: complaints_redressal@holaniconsultants.co.in<br>Contact Person: Mrs. Payal Jain<br>SEBI Registration No.: INM000012467 | <br><b>SHANNON ADVISORS PRIVATE LIMITED</b><br>902, 9th Floor, New Delhi House, Barakhamba Road, New Delhi – 110001<br>Tel.: +91 – 011 42758011<br>Website: <a href="http://www.shannon.co.in">www.shannon.co.in</a><br>Email: <a href="mailto:pavan@shannon.co.in">pavan@shannon.co.in</a><br>Investor Grievance ID: <a href="mailto:grievance@shannon.co.in">grievance@shannon.co.in</a><br>Contact Person: Mr. Pavan Kumar Agrawal<br>SEBI Registration No.: INM000013174 | <br><b>DOLAT FINSERV PRIVATE LIMITED</b><br>301-308, 3rd Floor, Bhagwati House, Plot A/19, Veera Desai, Andheri (West), Mumbai 400058<br>Tel.: +91 – 22 2673 2602<br>Website: <a href="http://www.dolatfinserv.com">www.dolatfinserv.com</a><br>Email: <a href="mailto:skyways.ipo@dolatfinserv.com">skyways.ipo@dolatfinserv.com</a><br>Investor Grievance ID: <a href="mailto:info@dolatfinserv.com">info@dolatfinserv.com</a><br>Contact Person: Mr. Souvik Chatterjee<br>SEBI Registration No.: INM000012643 | <br><b>BIGSHARE SERVICES PRIVATE LIMITED</b><br>Office No. S8-2, 6th Floor, Pinnacle Business Park, Next to Ahura Center, Mahakali Caves Road, Andheri (East), Mumbai – 400093<br>Tel: +91 22-6263 8200<br>Fax: +91 22-6263 8299<br>Website: <a href="http://www.bigshareonline.com">www.bigshareonline.com</a><br>Email: <a href="mailto:ipo@bigshareonline.com">ipo@bigshareonline.com</a><br>Investor Grievance ID: <a href="mailto:investor@bigshareonline.com">investor@bigshareonline.com</a><br>Contact Person: Mr. Vinayak Morbale<br>SEBI Registration Number: INR000001385 | <b>Hitesh Kumar</b><br>ACS No.: 33286<br>Tel: +91 – 9910791501<br>E-mail: <a href="mailto:cs@skyways-group.com">cs@skyways-group.com</a><br><br>Investors may contact the Company Secretary and Compliance Officer or the Registrar to the offer in case of any pre-offer or post-offer related grievances including non-receipt of letters of Allotment, non-credit of Allotted Equity Shares in the respective beneficiary account, non-receipt of refund orders or non-receipt of funds by electronic mode, etc. For all offer related queries and for redressal of complaints, investors may also write to the BRLMs. |                                          |

**AVAILABILITY OF THE RHP:** Investors are advised to refer to the RHP and the “Risk Factors” on page 29 of the RHP before applying in the Offer. A copy of the RHP will be made available on the website of SEBI at [www.sebi.gov.in](http://www.sebi.gov.in) and is available on the websites of the BRLMs, Holani Consultants Private Limited at [www.holaniconsultants.co.in](http://www.holaniconsultants.co.in), Shannon Advisors Private Limited at [www.shannon.co.in](http://www.shannon.co.in) and Dolat Finserv Private Limited at [www.dolatfinserv.com](http://www.dolatfinserv.com) and at the website of the Company, Skyways Air Services Limited at [www.skyways-air.in](http://www.skyways-air.in) and the websites of the Stock Exchanges, for BSE Limited at [www.bseindia.com](http://www.bseindia.com) and for National Stock Exchange of India Limited at [www.nseindia.com](http://www.nseindia.com).

**AVAILABILITY OF THE ABRIDGED PROSPECTUS:** A copy of the Abridged Prospectus shall be available on the website of the Company, the BRLMs and the Registrar to the Offer at: [www.skyways-air.in](http://www.skyways-air.in), [www.holaniconsultants.co.in](http://www.holaniconsultants.co.in), [www.shannon.co.in](http://www.shannon.co.in), [www.dolatfinserv.com](http://www.dolatfinserv.com) and [www.bigshareonline.com](http://www.bigshareonline.com), respectively.

**AVAILABILITY OF BID CUM APPLICATION FORM:** Bid cum Application Form can be obtained from the Registered Office of our Company, Skyways Air Services Limited, Tel: +91 – 9910791501 BRLMs: Holani Consultants Private Limited, Tel: +91 141 – 2203996, Shannon Advisors Private Limited, Tel: +91 – 011 42758011 and Dolat Finserv Private Limited, Tel: +91 – 222673 2602.

**SYNDICATE MEMBERS:** Holani Consultants Private Limited, Tel: +91 – 141 – 2203996 and Nikunj Stock Brokers Limited, Tel: +91-9811322534/ 011-47030017-18 Registered Brokers, SCSBs, Designated RTA Locations and Designated CDP Locations for participating in the Offer. Bid cum Application Forms will also be available on

**SKYWAYS AIR SERVICES LIMITED** is proposing, subject to receipt of requisite approvals, market conditions and other considerations, to make an initial public Offer of its Equity Shares and has filed a RHP dated August 11, 2026 with the RoC. The RHP is made available on the website of the SEBI at [www.sebi.gov.in](http://www.sebi.gov.in) as well as on the website of the BRLMs i.e. Holani Consultants Private Limited at [www.holaniconsultants.co.in](http://www.holaniconsultants.co.in), Shannon Advisors Private Limited at [www.shannon.co.in](http://www.shannon.co.in) and Dolat Finserv Private Limited at [www.dolatfinserv.com](http://www.dolatfinserv.com), the website of the NSE at [www.nseindia.com](http://www.nseindia.com) and the website of the BSE at [www.bseindia.com](http://www.bseindia.com) and the website of the Company at [www.skyways-air.in](http://www.skyways-air.in). Any potential investor should note that investment in Equity Shares involves a high degree of risk and should refer to the RHP, including the section titled “Risk Factors” on page 29 of the RHP. Potential Investors should not rely on the DRHP for making any investment decision but should only rely on the information included in the RHP filed by the Company with the RoC, the SEBI and the Stock Exchanges.

This announcement is not an offer of securities for sale in the United States or elsewhere. This announcement has been prepared for publication in India only and is not for publication or distribution, directly or indirectly, in or into the United States. The Equity Shares offered in the Offer have not been, and will not be, registered under the U.S. Securities Act of 1933 (the “U.S. Securities Act”) or any state securities laws in the United States, and unless so registered, may not be offered or sold within the United States, except pursuant to an exemption from, or in a transaction not subject to, the registration requirements of the U.S. Securities Act and applicable state securities laws. Accordingly, the Equity Shares are being offered and sold (i) within the United States only to persons reasonably believed to be “qualified institutional buyers” (as defined in Rule 144A under the U.S. Securities Act) in transactions exempt from, or not subject to, the registration requirements of the U.S. Securities Act, and (ii) outside the United States in offshore transactions as defined in and in reliance on Regulation S under the U.S. Securities Act and the applicable laws of the jurisdiction where those offers and sales occur.

CONCEPT





J CH-CE



**'COURTESY VISIT'**  
**Adani meets Karnataka CM, sets off speculation**  
**SOUTH » PAGE 7**

**RHINO HABITAT**  
**SC panel slams Assam govt. for inaction on mining**  
**NEWS » PAGE 12**





**BOOSTING CAPABILITIES**  
**India can be a hub for shipbuilding: Rajnath**  
**NEWS » PAGE 10**

**BETTER LEARNING**  
**Not 'delulu' — an AI tutor for every child**  
**Government can create required infrastructure**  
**EDITORIAL » PAGE 8**



**SHINING BRIGHT**  
**Padikkal hits century as India takes control**  
**SPORT » PAGE 15**

NEARBY

▼



Minister defends resting hall plan for devotees

**TIRUCHI**  
HR&CE Minister Ramesh has defended the proposal to construct a separate resting hall at Sri Mariamman Temple at Anbil for devotees cured of chickenpox. He accused the DMK of spreading false propaganda over this. » **PAGE 6**

Udhayanidhi slams TVK-led government

**CHENNAI**  
Leader of the Opposition Udhayanidhi Stalin on Sunday said CM C. Joseph Vijay was leading a “dummy government” in the State. » **PAGE 6**

**EDUCATIONPLUS » PAGE 2 & 5**

U.S. MoU best way out of war, says Iran President

Pezeshkian acknowledges ‘many problems’ faced by Iranians due to the ‘stalled war’; Tehran will follow policies set by its Supreme Leader; he says days after the end of the 60-day period for talks

**Associated Press**  
TEHRAN

Iran’s President Masoud Pezeshkian on Sunday defended a memorandum of understanding (MoU) with the United States as the best way out of a stalled war while also acknowledging that his country’s citizens face “many problems”.

The MoU signed in mid-June opened a 60-day period for talks aimed at ending the war, which began with strikes by the U.S. and Israel on Iran in February, and reaching an accord on Tehran’s nuclear programme.

That period ended last week, but no signs of compromise have emerged, especially on the crucial issue of reopening the Strait of Hormuz, the waterway



There is not a single provision in this agreement that amounts to capitulation... The Supreme Leader sets the policies, and we will follow that path  
**MASOUD PEZESHKIAN**  
Iran's President



If [Mr. Trump] wants to do something, we will retaliate in a seismic manner  
**MOHSEN REZAEI**  
Iran's Supreme National Security Council chief

vital to global shipping. The Iranian President on Sunday stressed that the MoU was key to move beyond the situation of “neither war nor peace”. “There is not a single provision in this agreement that amounts to capitulation,” Mr. Pezeshkian said

in a speech published by state-run IRNA. “The Supreme Leader sets the policies, and we will follow that path,” he added. Linking the deal to Iran’s economic prospects, Mr. Pezeshkian said the country cannot attract investment in this stalled

phase. Nearly six months into the war, Iran’s economy is suffering under U.S. sanctions and a naval blockade.

While Mr. Pezeshkian took a diplomatic stand, Mohsen Rezaei, the newly appointed leader of Iran’s Supreme National Security Council, appeared more defiant, warning neighbouring countries against supporting Washington’s threats to further sanction Tehran.

“If [U.S. President Donald Trump] wants to do something, we will retaliate in a seismic manner,” Mr. Rezaei told the state broadcaster in an interview aired on Saturday.

**CONTINUED ON**  
» **PAGE 10**  
**‘U.S. DESPERATION’**  
» **PAGE 14**

Search continues for 22 from vessel that sunk off Odisha

**Satyasundar Barik**  
**M. Kalyanaraman**  
BHUBANESWAR/CHENNAI

The fates of 22 crew members aboard a Panama-flagged bulk carrier that sank in the Bay of Bengal off Odisha remained unknown on Sunday even after 24 hours of intensive search and rescue operations by the Indian Navy and the Indian Coast Guard (ICG).

According to the latest reports from the Navy and the ICG, two Chinese crew members of the ill-fated *M.V. Ocean Winner*, which was carrying iron ore from Odisha, were rescued, even as Navy ships and aircraft continued to search for the remaining crew.

The ship, with 24 crew aboard – 20 from China, three from Myanmar, and one from Bangladesh – had left Paradip Port late on August 20. The ICG said that 36 hours after its departure, the Maritime Rescue Coordination Centre

Stormy voyage

The *MV Ocean Winner* with a 24-member crew had left the Paradip Port in Odisha on August 20

■ The Panama-flagged ship’s crew included 20 from China, three from Myanmar, and one from Bangladesh

■ The ship, built in 1998, has changed hands many times and its current owners are located in Fujian, China

■ During the last inspection of the ship in June, Bangladesh authorities reported three deficiencies, including in its magnetic compass



**Last leg:** The 28-year-old bulk carrier can haul a cargo of around 73,000 tonnes and was in its end-of-life period. FILE PHOTO

received information that communication with the vessel had been lost. It also received a request for a search and rescue operation.

The Eastern Naval Command said on X that it responded to the distress alert by deploying the P8I surveillance aircraft in coordination with MRCC, Sri Vijaya Puram. “The Indian Navy aircraft located a geographically dispersed liferaft in the area and soon

coordinated with *MT Aisopos*, which was transiting nearby, with a request for the merchant vessel to render assistance. By late evening on August 22, *MT Aisopos* had rescued two of the 24 crew members from the liferafts,” the Navy said.

The Navy said it continues to coordinate with the ICG in the operation to find the remaining crew.

**CONTINUED ON**  
» **PAGE 10**

Doval heads to China with eye on Xi’s visit

**Ananth Krishnan**  
BEIJING

National Security Adviser Ajit Doval is expected to visit Beijing on Monday and Tuesday for the 25th round of talks between the Special Representatives (SRs) on the boundary question, and ahead of a possible visit to India next month by Chinese President Xi Jinping. Mr. Doval’s visit and talks with Chinese Politburo member and Foreign Minister Wang Yi will also take stock of the broader bilateral relationship.

That the visit is taking place a few weeks before India’s hosting of the BRICS Summit on September 12 is an indication that both sides are preparing for a first visit by Mr. Xi in seven years, which would also likely include talks



Ajit Doval

with Prime Minister Narendra Modi.

A meeting between the two leaders in October 2024 on the sidelines of the BRICS summit in Kazan, Russia paved the way for what both sides see as a gradual and steady normalisation in relations. Mr. Modi and Mr. Xi last met in August last year.

**CONTINUED ON**  
» **PAGE 10**

Cong. flags ‘abnormal’ LS prorogation delay

**The Hindu Bureau**  
NEW DELHI

Flagging a 10-day delay in proroguing the Lok Sabha after it was adjourned *sine die* on August 13, in accordance with the schedule of the Monsoon Session of Parliament, Congress general secretary (communications) Jairam Ramesh on Sunday asked whether the “abnormal” time gap was an indication of the Centre’s efforts to cobble together the necessary numbers to clear the Bill on delimitation.

Under normal parliamentary practice, “the time gap between the adjournment of the Lok Sabha *sine die* and its prorogation is generally two to four days”, Mr. Ramesh said in a social media post. He also posted a photograph of a

page from *Practice and Procedure of Parliament* by M.N. Kaul and S.L. Shakdher, which underscored that prorogation, not adjournment, formally closes a session and clears the way for the next one to be convened.

The gap has occasionally run longer, including 28 days during the Monsoon Session of 2015, and 20 days in 2021, however, “there were no diabolical moves afoot then,” Mr. Ramesh said. “What explains the abnormal delay now? Is the Union Home Minister still in search of his *bahukalakit* (tarnished) 2/3rd majority to get the constitutional amendment Bill on delimitation passed in a special session?” he said.

**CONTINUED ON**  
» **PAGE 10**

T.N. to explore alternative sites for Chennai’s second airport, also keen on Hosur project

**Sunitha Sekar**  
CHENNAI

The Tamil Nadu government has decided to explore alternative sites for establishing Chennai’s second airport. At the same time, it is keen on building an airport at Hosur.

Chief Minister C. Joseph Vijay held a review meeting for Chennai’s second airport at the Secretariat recently. Sources said that within a few days, the government would likely disclose its plans for both airports.

This is significant since no Government Order has been issued on dropping the Parandur site for build-



**Facing uncertainty:** During the M.K. Stalin government, 1,700 acres of land was acquired, and site clearance and in-principle approval were obtained for the Parandur airport. FILE PHOTO

ing the second airport. Land acquisition has been stopped for some months now. The ruling TVK had opposed land acquisition for the Parandur airport before the election. During

the DMK government led by M.K. Stalin, 1,700 acres of land was acquired, and site clearance and in-principle approval were obtained for the project.

In the last few weeks,

the government considered the expansion of the Meenambakkam airport as well as a few sites for the second airport. Sources said a site in Chengalpet district was also considered. It is very unlikely that the government will reconsider the decision to build an airport at Parandur, a source said.

As for the Hosur airport, the government needs approval from the Defence Ministry for relaxation of the air space restrictions for the chosen site. The airport will definitely be built and the State will overcome the challenges from the air space restrictions, another source said.



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# Rain lashes many parts of city, suburbs

Many places like Meenambakkam, T. Nagar, and Tambaram witnessed intermittent rain with long spells of drizzling, leaving running water on many streets. Roads like Rajiv Gandhi Salai and GST were flooded at a few locations.

Chennai Run was presented by Casagrand, co-powered by AU Small Finance Bank, in association with Union Bank of India, Joyalukkas, and Andhra Pradesh Tourism. The associate partners were Life Insurance Corporation of India, Orchids The International School, and Sunfeast Supermilk. The education

PLANET member Prem Kumar said he had been observing the lake since 2015-16 and had never seen floating water hyacinth before. The lake was desilted around 2014 and had remained filled with water since the 2015 Chennai floods, unlike earlier years when it would dry up during summer. He suspected the growth of hyacinth could be linked to a government scheme introduced three to six months earlier, under which treated sewage water was being let into the lake.

and the pavement stalls near Parry's Corner taught me things no syllabus ever did. Chennai is not just one thing you can hold up and admire, it is a thousand small things that happen to you.

*(As told to Meghna M.)*

# Future belongs to those willing to learn, unlearn, and relearn: Speaker

**THE  HINDU**

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Tamil Nadu

INBRIEF



**‘Attempts to dilute glory of national song won’t succeed’**

Attempts to dilute the glory of the national song, *Vande Mataram*, for political appeasement can never succeed, BJP leader Vanathi Srinivasan said in a social media post on Sunday. “*Vande Mataram* is not merely a song, it is an emotion, a symbol of India's freedom struggle, and an eternal expression of our national pride,” she said. The BJP, she said, stood committed to restoring the honour of *Vande Mataram*, which inspired generations in the struggle for freedom. Her comments came after the BJP at the Centre adopted a resolution to protect the “honour and historical legacy of *Vande Mataram*”.

Efforts on to identify tiger that killed two men in the Nilgiris

The Forest Department is yet to identify the tiger responsible for killing two men at O’Valley in Gudalur of the Nilgiris district. Officials said that though they had spotted the tiger using a drone camera following the attack, they needed a clear image of the animal to identify it by matching its Unique ID with the records of the National Tiger Conservation Authority’s M-STriPEs. Divisional Forest Officer P. Devaraj said the animal could be a male tiger known to inhabit the area. He said investigations into the killing of the second victim, K. Ravikumar, 51, pointed to the tiger actively stalking him, unlike the accidental encounter on August 9 that led to the death of M. Balakrishnan, 58. Six cages had been placed in the area, and tracking teams deployed, he added.

DMK’s regional satraps among 22 who will lose district secretary posts

Thirty-three additional district units will be created and 55 new faces are likely to assume office as the DMK is set for a revamp following its defeat in the recent Assembly election, say party sources

B. Kolappan  
CHENNAI

With the principal opposition party in Tamil Nadu, the Dravida Munnetra Kazhagam (DMK), on the cusp of a revamp, several of its powerful regional satraps, including former Ministers, are set to make an exit from the organisational post of district secretaries.

The exercise, which is being undertaken in the wake of the party’s defeat in the recent Assembly election, will most likely see new faces in 50% of its district secretary posts.

The party’s high-level executive committee approved the new rules prescribed by the revamp committee headed by former Minister Thangam Thennarasu.

The party president and former Chief Minister M.K. Stalin had on Saturday informed party office-bearers of the proposed changes.

As per the recommendations, a district secretary can hold office for a maxi-



Complete overhaul: Chief Minister M.K. Stalin presiding over a high-level executive committee meeting on Saturday.

**Former Ministers S. Regupathy, Anitha Radhakrishnan, T.M. Anbarasan, and P. Moorthy are set to make an exit**

mum of three terms. The age limit for holding the post is 70.

Party sources said as many as 22 of the existing 77 district secretaries were ineligible to continue in the posts or contest the elections. As the revamp committee has recommended increasing the number of

district units to 110, 33 additional units will be created, which will also see new faces assuming office as district secretaries. In all, the changes are expected to bring 55 new faces to the post of district secretary.

The age limit and the three-term restriction will eliminate several important party faces, including former Ministers K.K.S.S.R. Ramachandran, Anitha Radhakrishnan, P. Moorthy, S. Muthusamy, T.M. Anbarasan, M.R.K. Panneerselvam, K.R. Periyakuruppan, S. Regupathy, former Speaker R. Avu-

daiappan, Theni Ramakrishnan, S.R. Sivalingam of Salem, Gingee Masthan, R. Gandhi, Sundar of Kancheepuram, former Kumbakonam MLA Sakkottai Anbazhagan, and Tiruvavur MLA Poondi S. Kalaivanan, from the race for district secretaries.

Mr. Stalin, while presiding over the high-level executive committee meeting on Saturday, said that although there were several reasons for the party’s defeat in the Assembly election, the performance of its functionaries was one of them. The new rules adopted by the high-level executive committee are aimed at infusing new blood into the organisation and giving more opportunities to youth and women.

The party is likely to announce the membership drive during the annual Mupperum Vizha in September. This will be followed by elections at various levels, including those to the post of district secretaries. The process will culminate in the appointment of state-level office-bearers.

T.N. Minister defends mandapam proposal at temple for devotees cured of chickenpox

C. Jaisankar  
TIRUCHI

Defending the announcement of an exclusive mandapam (resting hall) for devotees cured of chickenpox at Sri Mariamman Temple at Anbil, Minister for Hindu Religious and Charitable Endowments (HR&CE) Ramesh on Sunday accused the DMK of spreading false propaganda to demean the government.

Speaking to reporters in Tiruchi, Mr. Ramesh said the proposed mandapam was for those who visited the temple after recovering from chickenpox. The temple drew a large number of devotees from across the State, many of whom wanted to stay at the temple to fulfil their vows to the goddess if they were cured of chickenpox, he said.

The government had announced the construction of the mandapam upon receiving several petitions from devotees and considering the rising number of visitors. However, the DMK launched a false propaganda campaign online, claiming that the mandapam would spread the disease as those with chickenpox would congregate there, the Minister said.

He further said that Mi-



Ramesh

**The HR&CE Minister says many devotees stay at the temple after recovering from chickenpox to fulfil their religious vows**

nisters and the TVK MLAs had been strictly adhering to the dignity of the House. However, the DMK members had been following a disruptive approach by causing ruckus in the Assembly, he said.

On criticism levelled by the Opposition that Chief Minister C. Joseph Vijay did not bother to answer the questions directed at him, Mr. Ramesh said many Ministers actively responding to the questions directed at the Chief Minister, and that there was nothing wrong in that as they too were part of the government.

Life convict Selvam’s prison memoir *Oru Thooku Kaithiyin Vaakumoolam* wins Iyal award of Canada

B. Kolappan  
CHENNAI

*Oru Thooku Kaithiyin Vaakumoolam* (The Testimony of a Death Warrant Prisoner), penned by life convict C. Selvam, has been selected for the Iyal Award for non-fiction by the Canada-based Tamil Literary Garden.

This is probably the first time that the award is being given to a writer who spent 32 years in prison.

“I consider it an award for my reading. I could not study beyond Class IX, and reading sustained me in prison all these years,” said Selvam, who is lodged in the Vellore prison and is currently out on parole.

Selvam, a native of Thenthamarikulam in Kanniyakumari district,



said Sundara Ramaswamy, S. Ramakrishnan, Nanjil Nadan, and Jeyamohan were among his favourite authors. He also received a congratulatory message from Sri Lankan writer A. Muthulingam, who lives in Canada.

Selvam and his associates surrendered before a court in Nagercoil in connection with a murder in 1994. Though he and his friends Radhakrishnan and Shiekmeeran were

I consider it an award for my reading. I could not study beyond Class IX, and reading sustained me in prison all these years

C. SELVAM

awarded the death sentence, it was later commuted to life imprisonment by the President on the condition that they spend the rest of their lives in prison.

In prison, Selvam began reading voraciously, and this resulted in the memoir that was released in December 2025.

It was made possible by publishing house Kizhakku Pathippagam’s Badri Seshadri, who had a chance encounter with Selvam in the

Tiruchi jail, where he was lodged in connection with his alleged remarks against the judiciary. Justice K. Chandru wrote the foreword to the book.

**Calls for prison reforms**

The book, which surpasses gripping crime thrillers and films, strongly advocates prison reforms and records life behind bars. Justice Chandru said he had decided to write the foreword because Selvam had written the truth.

Mr. Seshadri said the book was likely to win many awards, as it had touched people across multiple domains, not only through its literary aspects but also through the manner in which it dealt with legal issues. “It has made a significant impact on the

legal fraternity, including judges,” he said.

**Other awardees**

A press release from the Tamil Literary Garden said the lifetime achievement award would go to Trotsky Marudu, and the award for fiction to Thirusenthalai; non-fiction to C. Selvan and Sankar Saravanan; poetry to Karunakaran; and translation to Geetha Sukumaran.

President of the Tamil Literary Garden V. Venkataramanan said the Lifetime Achievement Award carries a cash prize of C\$2,500, while the others carry C\$1,000 each.

The award organisers have asked Selvam to deputate a representative to collect the award on October 18.

Udhayanidhi slams TVK, says Vijay leads a ‘dummy govt.’

C. Jaisankar  
TIRUCHI

Leader of the Opposition Udhayanidhi Stalin on Sunday said Chief Minister C. Joseph Vijay was leading a “dummy government” in the State.

Speaking at a wedding function at Pattukottai in Thanjavur district, he said the TVK government had done nothing for the people of Tamil Nadu since it assumed office, and had implemented none of the promises made in its election manifesto. Mr. Vijay was not bothered about the problems faced by the people, and was leading the State as a “dummy” Chief Minister, he added.

Mr. Udhayanidhi said the farmers had been the worst-affected since the



Udhayanidhi Stalin

TVK came to power. The Mettur dam was opened on time, and on some occasions well ahead of schedule, in the previous DMK regime, with then Chief Minister M.K. Stalin ensuring timely release of water for irrigation, he said.

More than two months after the scheduled date (June 12), the dam is yet to be opened, Mr. Udhayanidhi said, adding that it had

severely affected paddy cultivation in delta districts this ‘kuruvai’ season.

He had brought it to the TVK-led government’s attention in the Assembly and demanded drought relief for the farmers. But the Chief Minister, ignorant of the difference between the kuruvai package and drought relief, said the government had already announced a kuruvai package for the farmers, Mr. Udhayanidhi said.

He said the TVK government had claimed that there were no funds for drought relief and total crop loan waiver, but had announced cars for the MLAs. He further alleged that Mr. Vijay preferred not to answer the questions raised by the DMK members in the Assembly.

‘Withdraw letter on surveilling students, youth staging protests’

The Hindu Bureau  
CHENNAI

The State Platform for Common School System-Tamil Nadu (SPCSS-T.N.) urged the Chief Minister to declare the Chief Secretary’s directive to surveil protesting youth null and void and direct the Public Department to withdraw the letter.

In a letter to Chief Minister C. Joseph Vijay, SPCSS-T.N. sought the minutes of the July 28 law and order review meeting, which discussed the participation of students and youth in protests. “It is further requested that the Chief Minister present the correct facts before the Legislative Assembly,” the letter added.

This is in regard to the State government’s circulars directing colleges and universities to prevent students from participating in

protests organised by the Left parties and the Cockroach Janta Party.

SPCSS-T.N. General Secretary P.B. Prince Gajendra Babu said the statements of the Ministers in the Legislative Assembly made it clear that they were not informed of a major decision taken at the review meeting chaired by the Chief Secretary.

“In a parliamentary democracy, the elected executive, the Council of Ministers, guides the bureaucracy. The Council of Ministers, which is answerable to the legislature and the people, should be informed of every action of the government. In the present instance, the Chief Secretary failed to keep the Council of Ministers informed of the decisions taken at the law and order review meeting held on July 28,” the letter said.

Hero stone inscription from the Fifth Century unearthed

N. Sai Charan  
CHENNAI

A hero stone inscription, dating back to the Sangam period, has been unearthed by archaeologists at Malayadipatti village near Karivalamvandalalur in Tenkasi district, where the Tamil Nadu State Department of Archaeology (TNSDA) is conducting excavations.

According to official sources in the TNSDA, the inscription was found in a brick well with steps, which was in use during the Sangam period. It appears to have fallen into disuse in later years, and subsequently filled with stones and bricks. The hero stone was found among the materials used to fill the well.

Official sources said the hero stone measures 1 m in length and 0.30 m in width.

The inscription on the hero stone is in a script re-



Ancient honour: The hero stone unearthed by archaeologists in a brick well at Malayadipatti in Tenkasi district. SPECIAL ARRANGEMENT

presenting a transitional stage from Tamil-Brahmi to Vattezhuthu. It contains four lines: ‘Karukkan’, ‘Sulagan’, ‘Nannang’ and ‘Kodiyam’. Archaeologists interpret it as an indication that the hero stone was erected in memory of Nannang Kodiyam, son of Karukkan Sulagan in the Fifth Century.

During the Sangam and post-Sangam periods, figures were not carved on hero stones. Those found

at Pulimankombai, Aappanur and Mallikapuram, for instance, do not bear depictions of the warriors. Similarly, the hero stone unearthed at Malayadipatti does not depict the warrior, official sources further said.

Excavations at Malayadipatti have revealed a range of artefacts that shed light on the life, occupation, and trade of the people who lived there during the Sangam period.

Over 56,000 allotted seats after third round of TNEA counselling

The Hindu Bureau  
CHENNAI

A total of 56,294 candidates have been allotted seats at the end of the third round of counselling of Tamil Nadu Engineering Admissions (TNEA) 2026.

A TNEA press release said that in the general category, 48,501 students got provisional allotment, while 6,183 students who opted for upward mobility were given tentative allotment.

Similarly, in the horizontal reservation category (7.5% reservation for government school students), 1,172 students were given provisional allotment, while 438 secured tentative allotment.

Students who secured provisional allotment are required to report to the respective colleges and complete the admission

process on or before August 27. Correspondingly, students who got tentative allotment are required to visit the TNEA Facilitation Centre (TFC) as provided in their option, surrender their certificates, and pay the tuition fees mentioned in the allotment order on or before August 27. This will confirm their current seats, even while facilitating upward movement if better seats open up after the admission process is over.

The TNEA committee has warned that students who do not report to the designated college or the TFCs within the stipulated time will have their seats cancelled. Those seats will then be pooled back into the process and allotted to those who have opted for upward mobility and completed the formalities at the TFCs.

Man caught in illegal electric fence dies

The Hindu Bureau  
SIVAGANGA

A 29-year-old kabaddi player, R. Muthusangu, died after getting caught in an electric fence set up illegally in a coconut grove near Thiruppachethi.

The grove owner, Dinakaran, spotted Muthusangu’s body in the morning and informed the police. He was arrested after a complaint from the victim’s father.

Correction

In the report “HC dismisses A. Raja’s plea in disproportionate assets case” in edition dated August 22, 2026, the headline should read “Madras High Court dismisses A. Raja’s plea to direct CBI to furnish documents in assets case” and not as published.



N. Ram, Director, The Hindu Group; Pratik Sinha, founder, *Alt News*; Syeda Faiza, digital editor, *The Siasat Daily*; and moderator Uma Sudhir in Hyderabad on Sunday. NAGARA GOPAL

## Original reporting is key to restoring trust in media, says N. Ram

**The Hindu Bureau**  
HYDERABAD

N. Ram, eminent journalist and Director of The Hindu Group, has called for a return to the fundamentals of journalism, including ground reporting, investigative journalism, long-form journalism and explanatory writing, to help the media regain public trust.

Mr. Ram also called for media literacy to be introduced in school curricula to help students understand and critically evaluate news and information.

Speaking at a panel discussion at the National Conclave of the Federation of Press Clubs in Hyderabad on Sunday, Mr. Ram stressed the need for transparent codes of conduct for journalists, independent self-regulation, and a statutory framework for regulation.

“I think it really helps to build trust. Then it comes to self-regulation for the whole industry,” he said.

Mr. Ram said self-regulatory mechanisms should

comprise journalists and respected media personalities. He also suggested that codes of conduct should have the backing of legislation enacted by Parliament.

“Investigative journalism is forte of print journalism. Long-form writing, data reporting and explanatory reports could help the print media strengthen its credibility,” he said.

Mr. Ram also expressed concern over the impact of media ownership on journalistic standards and advocated reader-funded models of journalism. He cited successful news platforms, including *Alt News* and *The Wire*, as examples of alternative models.

Another panellist, Pratik Sinha, the co-founder and editor at *Alt News*, also stressed the need to develop new economic models for journalism.

Digital Desk Editor of *The Siasat Daily*, Syeda Faiza Kirmani, said print media continued to play an important role by providing in-depth and accurate information.

## Adani calls on Karnataka CM, sparks political speculation

Shivakumar terms meeting a courtesy visit; Opposition leader R. Ashok takes a dig at Congress; Adani Group is the lowest bidder for Bengaluru’s North-South twin tube tunnel road project

**The Hindu Bureau**  
BENGALURU

A meeting between Adani Group chairman Gautam Adani and Karnataka Chief Minister D.K. Shivakumar here on Sunday set off speculation in political circles. While the Chief Minister termed it a courtesy visit, the Adani Group is an interested bidder in the tunnel road project in Bengaluru being pushed by Mr. Shivakumar.

Government sources said the meeting was unscheduled, and that Mr. Adani, who was attending a private function in Bengaluru South was on his way to the airport, when

Rahul Gandhi has called Mr. Adani a BJP agent. However, the Karnataka government has rolled out a red carpet for Mr. Adani. Have the [Central] Congress leaders given permission for this? So, let them advise Mr. Gandhi properly

**R. ASHOK**  
Karnataka Opposition leader



he dropped in at the Chief Minister’s residence.

Incidentally, the Adani Group has emerged as the lowest bidder for the 17.1-km Bengaluru North-South twin tube tunnel road project, estimated to cost around ₹17,000 crore.

Of the total cost of the

project that has been proposed on a the build-own-operate-transfer (BOOT) model, the government is expected to invest 40% through viability gap funding, financed by a loan from the Housing and Urban Development Corporation (HUDCO). The Adani

Group is learnt to have quoted just above ₹22,000 crore for the project.

Taking a dig at the Congress, Leader of Opposition in the Assembly R. Ashok said: “[Leader of Opposition in Lok Sabha] Rahul Gandhi has called Mr. Adani a BJP agent. However, the Karnataka government has rolled out a red carpet for Mr. Adani. Have the [Central] Congress leaders given permission for this? So, let them advise Mr. Gandhi properly.”

### ‘Courtesy visit’

Mr. Shivakumar told reporters here: “Mr. Adani paid a courtesy visit after I became the Chief Minister.”

## Pinarayi accuses UDF govt. of yielding to BJP, RSS on Waqf law

**The Hindu Bureau**  
MALAPPURAM

Keralam’s Leader of the Opposition Pinarayi Vijayan has accused the Congress-led United Democratic Front (UDF) government had not appointed two non-Muslim members to the Waqf Board. In contrast, he said, the UDF government told the Bharatiya Janata Party (BJP) and Sangh Parivar on issues including the Waqf law.

Inaugurating a seminar on “Waqf law and UDF surrender” organised by the Communist Party of India

(Marxist) here on Sunday, Mr. Vijayan pointed out that the previous Left Democratic Front (LDF) government had not appointed two non-Muslim members to the Waqf Board. In contrast, he said, the UDF government told the Bharatiya Janata Party (BJP) and Sangh Parivar on issues including the Waqf law.

He questioned why the government should allow non-Muslims to be appointed to a Muslim religious institution. He al-

leged that such a move reflected a communal mindset and warned that similar interventions could target institutions of other religions.

He also alleged that the decision to sing the full version of *Vande Mataram* at the government’s swearing-in ceremony reflected a surrender to the Rashtriya Swayamsevak Sangh (RSS) agenda.

Mr. Vijayan said the Congress was aligning with RSS policies.

## Revanth cuts short visit, to return to India today

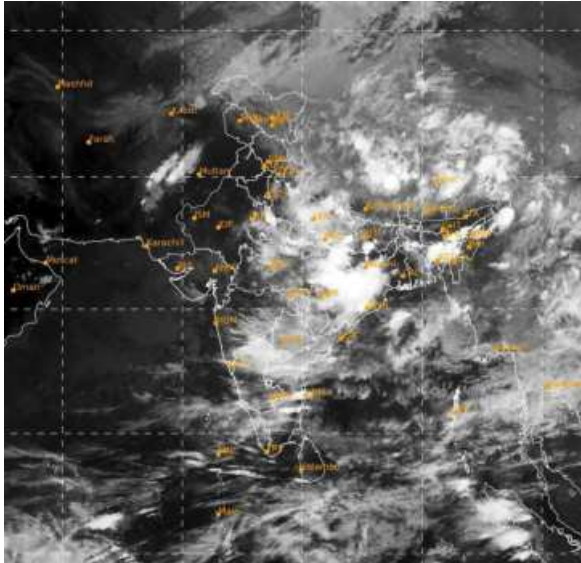
**The Hindu Bureau**  
HYDERABAD

Telangana Chief Minister A. Revanth Reddy said he would speak about all the issues related to the denial of permission by the Centre for his United States tour, after returning to Hyderabad.

Mr. Reddy cut short his visit to the U.S. and London and is returning from London early on Monday.

## WEATHERWATCH

Rainfall, temperature & air quality in select metros yesterday



**Forecast for Monday:** Heavy to very heavy rain likely at isolated places over Assam, Meghalayam, Nagaland, Manipur, Tripura, north Tamil Nadu, east Rajasthan, Madhya Pradesh and Gujarat region. Heavy rain likely at isolated places over Chhattisgarh, coastal Karnataka and Lakshadweep

| CITY        | RAIN  | MAX  | MIN  | CITY               | RAIN | MAX  | MIN  |
|-------------|-------|------|------|--------------------|------|------|------|
| Agartala    | 145.8 | 35.2 | 24.8 | Kurnool            | 0.2  | 35.6 | 25.4 |
| Ahmedabad   | —     | 33.0 | 26.4 | Lucknow            | 0.6  | 35.1 | 27.0 |
| Aizawl      | 1.2   | 31.8 | 24.1 | Madurai            | —    | 39.0 | 26.0 |
| Bangaluru   | 1.6   | 27.3 | 20.4 | Mangaluru          | 9.7  | 28.5 | 24.4 |
| Bhopal      | —     | 31.6 | 23.6 | Mumbai             | 3.0  | 31.5 | 25.5 |
| Bhubaneswar | 1.2   | 31.4 | 26.0 | Mysuru             | 1.0  | 29.4 | 19.4 |
| Chandigarh  | 0.5   | 32.9 | 25.9 | New Delhi          | —    | 32.4 | 24.8 |
| Chennai     | 0.7   | 36.0 | 27.2 | Patna              | 1.0  | 35.9 | 28.1 |
| Coimbatore  | —     | 32.4 | 22.6 | Port Blair         | —    | 7.9  | 30.0 |
| Dehradun    | 0.8   | 31.2 | 24.3 | Prayagraj          | —    | 62.0 | 32.6 |
| Gangtok     | 46.6  | 24.7 | 18.5 | Puducherry         | —    | 36.4 | 25.3 |
| Goa         | 4.3   | —    | —    | Pune               | 1.2  | 26.4 | 21.0 |
| Guwahati    | 1.8   | 34.3 | 26.4 | Raipur             | —    | 26.7 | 31.0 |
| Hubballi    | —     | 27.7 | 22.2 | Ranchi             | 4.0  | 31.6 | 23.0 |
| Hyderabad   | 26.0  | 27.9 | 23.0 | Shillong           | 0.1  | 27.3 | 18.5 |
| Imphal      | —     | 31.3 | 23.1 | Shimla             | —    | 11.8 | 27.5 |
| Jaipur      | —     | —    | 27.2 | Srinagar           | —    | 9.0  | 27.4 |
| Kochi       | 12.2  | 31.0 | 24.6 | Thiruvananthapuram | 3.5  | 30.7 | 24.5 |
| Kohima      | —     | —    | —    | Tiruchirappalli    | —    | 39.1 | 27.6 |
| Kolkata     | 21.7  | 37.5 | 26.8 | Vijayawada         | 3.5  | 36.9 | 24.6 |
| Kozhikode   | 1.7   | 33.2 | 25.5 | Visakhapatnam      | 1.5  | 31.7 | 25.6 |

(Rainfall data in mm; temperature in Celsius)

**Pollutants in the air you are breathing**

| CITIES        | SO <sub>2</sub> | NO <sub>2</sub> | CO  | PM <sub>2.5</sub> | PM <sub>10</sub> | CODE   | Yesterday                                                                                                                                                                                                              |
|---------------|-----------------|-----------------|-----|-------------------|------------------|--------|------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Ahmedabad     | 31              | 40              | 118 | 156               | 214              | Red    | In observation made at 4.00 p.m., Leh, Ladakh recorded an overall air quality index (AQI) score of 207 indicating an unhealthy level of pollution. In contrast, Madikeri, Karnataka recorded a healthy AQI score of 12 |
| Bangaluru     | —               | —               | 34  | —                 | 92               | Green  |                                                                                                                                                                                                                        |
| Chennai       | —               | 41              | 57  | 99                | 126              | Orange |                                                                                                                                                                                                                        |
| Delhi         | 64              | 74              | 125 | 94                | 108              | Yellow |                                                                                                                                                                                                                        |
| Hyderabad     | —               | 17              | 17  | 45                | 60               | Green  |                                                                                                                                                                                                                        |
| Kolkata       | 26              | 31              | 43  | 37                | 84               | Green  |                                                                                                                                                                                                                        |
| Lucknow       | —               | 44              | 50  | 42                | 159              | Orange |                                                                                                                                                                                                                        |
| Mumbai        | 26              | 69              | 37  | 59                | 84               | Green  |                                                                                                                                                                                                                        |
| Pune          | 59              | 41              | 45  | 75                | 59               | Green  |                                                                                                                                                                                                                        |
| Visakhapatnam | 13              | 65              | 26  | 33                | 65               | Green  |                                                                                                                                                                                                                        |

**Air Quality Code:** Red Poor Moderate Good (Readings indicate average AQI)

**SO<sub>2</sub>:** Sulphur Dioxide. Short-term exposure can harm the respiratory system, making breathing difficult. It can affect visibility by reacting with other air particles to form haze and stain culturally important objects such as statues and monuments.

**NO<sub>2</sub>:** Nitrogen Dioxide. Aggravates respiratory illness, causes haze to form by reacting with other air particles, causes acid rain, pollutes coastal waters.

**CO:** Carbon monoxide. High concentration in air reduces oxygen supply to critical organs like the heart and brain. At very high levels, it can cause dizziness, confusion, unconsciousness and even death.

**PM<sub>2.5</sub> & PM<sub>10</sub>:** Particulate matter pollution can cause irritation of the eyes, nose and throat, coughing, chest tightness and shortness of breath, reduced lung function, irregular heartbeat, asthma attacks, heart attacks and premature death in people with heart or lung disease

## INBRIEF



### ED searches residence of IAS officer in KPSC ‘scam’ case

A day after IAS officer and MSME Director Gyanendra Kumar Gangwar returned from his hometown in Uttar Pradesh after being out of contact for nearly two days, Enforcement Directorate (ED) officials on Sunday reportedly arrived at his residence in Bengaluru in connection with the ongoing probe into alleged irregularities in Karnataka Public Service Commission recruitment. The veterinary officer recruitment exam has come under the ED’s scanner following claims that candidates were asked to pay huge sums of money.

### HC allows cancer patient to join plea on medicine prices

The Kerala High Court has allowed a breast cancer patient from Malappuram to be impleaded in a petition on the issue of the ‘exorbitant’ price of breast cancer medication, Ribociclib. The petition was initially filed by another patient diagnosed with HR Positive HER2-Negative Metastatic Breast Cancer. Her plea sought directives to the government to take over the medication’s patent and make it available at the lowest price possible. The court had taken up the matter *suo motu* following her death.

### Non-resident Keralites will get pension before Onam: CM

The Keralam government has authorised the release of ₹32 crore for the payment of welfare pensions to non-resident Keralites. The ‘pravasi’ welfare pension had been in arrears for some months. The pension will be credited before Onam, Chief Minister V.D. Satheesan’s office said. The State government said the arrears had piled up on account of the previous LDF government diverting the funds for other purposes. The pension is paid at the rate of ₹3,500 for Keralites who are abroad and ₹3,000 to individuals who are working in other States or have returned.

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## Triple test, adrift

The Supreme Court should not have discarded a workable test on ‘industry’

On August 20, a nine-judge Bench of the Supreme Court of India delivered a judgment on the correctness of the ruling in *Bangalore Water Supply and Sewerage Board vs A. Rajappa (BWSSB)* (1978). In that judgment, Justice V.R. Krishna Iyer had laid down what was called the “Triple Test” on what counts as an “industry” under Section 2(j) of the Industrial Disputes (ID) Act, 1947 (ID Act). Three conditions were to be met for an industry – a systematic activity, employer-employee cooperation, and production/distribution of goods and services to satisfy human wants other than those that are purely religious or spiritual. Profit motive was irrelevant; what mattered in this determination was the nature of the activity, and only “sovereign functions” stood outside it. A five-judge Bench in *State of U.P. vs Jai Bir Singh* (2005) raised a doubt about this definition and a seven-judge Bench sent it to the current nine-judge Bench. This Bench, led by Chief Justice of India Surya Kant, left the Triple Test standing for all pending disputes under the older ID Act, which was repealed on November 21, 2025 when the Industrial Relations Code, 2020 (IRC) came into force. However, a majority of the nine-judge Bench also ruled that *BWSSB* will not be a “sheet anchor” for interpreting Section 2(p) of the IRC. That is a mistake. In her dissenting opinion, Justice B.V. Nagarathna held that the reference itself was unnecessary and that the Triple Test requires no interference – a view shared by three other judges. Her reasoning is compelling. Since 1978, and particularly after the liberalisation and privatisation reforms of 1991, a far higher number of workers have moved to the private sector, out of the security of public employment. An expansive definition of industry, as entailed in the Triple Test, is therefore even more necessary now as a bulwark for the worker.

Yet, Section 2(p) of the IRC does not move away from Justice Krishna Iyer’s Triple Test formula in *BWSSB* and reproduces much of its essence. It is therefore difficult to understand why *BWSSB* has to be set aside when Section 2(p) itself comes up for interpretation. The Triple Test was also not merely a pro-labour device. An expansive definition of industry brought with it not just the ID Act’s protections but also its restrictions – for instance, a regulated route to retrenchment and closure for the employer, and a bar on workers striking at will. In essence, the Triple Test allowed for industrial peace rather than worker welfare alone. Severing that principle from the IRC, as the majority has done, cuts away the interpretive framework that allowed such disputes to be resolved. With the essence of the Triple Test carried into Section 2(p), it is now incumbent upon courts and tribunals to ensure that a change of statute is not read as a change of intent even if the majority judgment has removed the anchor to do so.

## Core concerns

The Indian economy looks set for tough times ahead

The slowdown in the growth of India’s core industrial sectors in July was not surprising, with other indicators predicting easing demand conditions as well. Growth in the index of core industries (ICI) slowed to 5.4% in July from 6% in the previous month. This was in keeping with the Manufacturing Purchasing Managers’ Index, which in July eased to its lowest level since August 2021 due to weak domestic demand conditions. While July’s growth in the ICI was the second-highest growth rate in the last seven months, the data nevertheless highlight some concerning aspects of the Indian economy. The first has to do with the fact that a large part of even this slower growth seems to be based on a statistical low base effect. The coal sector, for example, grew at an 11-month high of 7.6% in July, but this was based on a contraction of 12.3% in July of last year. Similarly, the refinery products sector snapped a three-month streak of contraction to grow at 2.7%, but this too was based on a contraction in July 2025. The iron ore sector, however, grew at a very robust 29.5%, albeit slower than a blistering 44.5% in June. This seems heartening regardless of the contractions of 16.4% and 7.1% in June and July of last year, respectively. But the steel sector slowed drastically in July to 2.9% from 5.6% in June and 15.7% in July of last year.

The domestic crude oil and natural gas sectors have been lasting drags on the economy. Both have contracted continuously for at least the last 14 months for which the new series of the ICI has data. India’s crude oil imports rose 13.3% in volume terms in July, while Liquefied Natural Gas (LNG) imports grew a more marginal 1.5%, showing that the economy’s appetite is being whetted from abroad. This external dependence is proving very expensive. High oil prices have meant that the crude oil import bill jumped 41% in July. The 100% tariffs that the United States is preparing to levy on countries such as India that import Russian oil will once again burden Indian exporters. Moving to 20% ethanol-blending has not yet impacted oil imports materially. Within the ICI, the only two bright spots of the economy were the cement and electricity sectors. The electricity sector grew at a robust 9% in July, although this was slower than the two consecutive months of double-digit growth in May and June thanks to the prevalent heatwave conditions in many parts of the country. The cement sector sped up to 13.1%, a welcome acceleration. Such positive trends were few and far between. Overall, the Indian economy looks to be in for a period of slack demand, higher costs, and moderating growth.

Indian students rank among the top students almost anywhere in the world. The joke is that, from the womb to the afterlife, they are taught to study maths and science which serves them well throughout life. A report by Redseer says that India’s test-preparation market has been estimated at \$14.8 billion in FY26, projected to reach \$23-\$26 billion by FY30 (12%-15% CAGR), with around 2,00,000 coaching centres nationwide. There are 65 million students in classes 9-12, of whom around 27 million attend government schools. A 2025 National Statistical Office survey found that 27% of students were taking or had taken private coaching in the academic year (30.7% urban, 25.5% rural). Across datasets, coaching incidence is around 27%-30%, implying that 17 million to 20 million students in classes 9-12 participate in some form of test-prep coaching.

No single private platform has the capacity or curriculum breadth to serve as the sole national provider. PhysicsWallah, for example, has around 4.9 million paid online users – while the target population is 10 to 100 times larger. This needs to be built as a platform and network play, not a vendor contract.

### Better learning, better outcomes

How can the government take the help of Artificial Intelligence (AI) to deliver a free coach and tutor to every Indian child? The objective should not be to bring down the private coaching industry but to improve the learning standards and examination outcomes of the last child in the line who today spends thousands of rupees on dubious coaching centres without achieving the necessary results. Bring the industry in as suppliers, or they will lobby against it and the reputational risk of failing completely, is high for the government to sustain.

We should not nationalise coaching. Build a public rail, private engines model: the state supplies the digital public infrastructure (identity, payments, discovery, data, credentialing) and aggregates demand; the private sector – star teachers, ed-tech firms, local tutors – supplies content and last-mile delivery shared by both. Government becomes the platform and market-maker, not the content producer. This is exactly how UPI beat closed payment apps and how the pen Network for Digital Commerce is attempting to beat closed commerce: unbundle the monopoly, open the protocol, let a thousand providers compete on an open network.

The Indian coaching industry charges high fees because it bundles four things that do not have to be bundled: content; doubt-solving/mentoring; peer group and discipline, a credible signal of quality. DPI lets us unbundle these and drive the marginal cost of the first two toward zero. This can be anchored in an existing centre of excellence such as Bodhan.ai at IIT Madras



Srivatsa Krishna  
IAS officer

The government can create the digital infrastructure for every Indian child to access a free Artificial Intelligence (AI) tutor – which was the vision behind the Prime Minister’s call

(which has a ₹500 crore, five year government grant) or a similar National Payments Corporation of India (NPCI)-like body that needs to be created for education (a Section 8 not-for-profit steward).

### Where it should begin

It should start with the National Eligibility cum Entrance Test (Undergraduate), or NEET, and the Joint Entrance Examination, the two most widely taken examinations in India. JEE/NEET are objective, machine-gradable, and high-volume. The content is already freely available on YouTube; what is scarce is a trusted, standardised rank signal and personalised doubt-solving.

An IIT professor who teaches students who have cleared JEE 30 years ago may not be the best option for teaching test prep. Today’s test prep skill and requirement is in a very different age, time, and pedagogy.

Government aggregates demand thereby drives down the customer acquisition cost for the private sector and owns the rails and the trust layer; the private sector and star teachers compete to deliver content and mentoring on an open network; the student owns the data and carries a voucher (optional). That is how you turn a \$15b payroll industry into free, plural, high-quality prep – without the state trying to become the teacher.

As with any private good using public rails, it will use Aadhaar/DigiLocker for student sign-up and to de-duplicate; APAAR ID to tie learning to the academic record. Along with this will be a curated content registry, an open catalogue where any accredited provider publishes lessons, problem sets, and mock tests against a standard syllabus taxonomy (NEET/JEE topic tree) and open metadata (language, difficulty, medium, accessibility tags). The government will set the taxonomy and standards for the content and ensure interoperability.

Content interoperability is the whole game – a student’s progress in one provider’s module must be portable to another’s. There shall be a discovery layer, a government-run reference app plus open APIs so third parties (including the DIKSHA app, state apps, even Google/YouTube) can surface the same content – multiple front ends, one network. For example, PhysicsWallah, Vedantu, Allen or Narayana could offer their material for free and charge for doubt-solving or premium sessions with ranked professors. IIT professors could also upload their lectures and be rated and ranked on the platform. Adaptive personalisation should be a core feature and as a network service, an open recommendation/diagnostic engine that routes say a weak-in-organic-chemistry student to the best-rated module on that topic, regardless of provider. These will be accompanied by a learning wallet and a progress ledger, a student-owned record of what they have studied,

mock scores, and mastery per topic, consent-gated through the DEPA/Account Aggregator pattern. The student – not the ed-tech firm – owns the data, which is the single biggest structural break from today’s walled-garden apps. Lastly, while the platform will be mostly free at the point of use, UPI-plumbed premium add-ons (live mentoring, graded assignments) can be micro-charged or voucher-funded, should the government wish to create a DBT-like e-Shiksha wallet. Deliberately thin the government software: The state builds protocols and a reference app; it does not try to build the best learning app. It will not win that race and should not try this. Government alone can aggregate the demand and credential the supply and outcomes – that is all it should do. It should auto-invite every registered Class 11-12 student through schools, CBSE/State boards, and the DIKSHA install base. The system should guarantee reach through free data-light streaming, downloadable content for low-bandwidth areas, and distribution through the five lakh-plus Common Service Centres and school computer labs for students without personal devices. Equity is the mandate – the ₹60,000 crore industry already serves the affluent; the gap is everyone else.

Government should publish open ratings and outcome data: publish, per provider and per module, how students who used it scored on official mocks and the real exam. Quality signal becomes objective, not marketing. This is the credential the coaching industry currently monopolises. Government alone can ensure independent accreditation of providers (content accuracy, no misleading claims), with delisting teeth. Further there should be a no-lock-in rule to ensure that providers cannot hold a student’s progress data hostage; portability is enforced at the protocol level.

### Models on offer

There is no dearth of content, good and bad, on YouTube but where an AI tutor helps is in practice, doubt solving and adaptive personalisation, which only AI can do. There are good open-source models such as Gemma, which give a million tokens for about 20 to 30 cents or 10,000 tokens per day or 3.6 million tokens per year for just ₹100. Further, every AI minute is equivalent to 1,000 voice minutes of a human; frontier tech companies such as Meta and Google are paying star Kota teachers \$25 to \$30 per hour for commoditising their content. Further, their models will get trained on it and Generative Inference will do the rest on top of it.

We should not be delulu – as Gen Z would put it – government should not become the AI tutor itself. It should only enable the AI tutor through the blueprint given.

The views expressed are personal

# The return of profanation as a new political language

In his work *Profanations*, Italian philosopher Giorgio Agamben observes how the act of profanation applies to the game of chess and children playing with household items as toys. For Agamben, profanation refers to removal or transfer of objects, places, animals, personalities or languages from the realm of sacred or restricted use to the common or ordinary use of people. Religion, state, political ideology, and marketplace are identified by him as the agents that make things sacred, removing them from common use and transferring them to a separate sphere. What chess does is profanation, converting wars or ancient divinatory rituals into a game, a playful activity.

The same thing happens when a child plays with a household object; they free or liberate it from its restricted use and open it up for a new purpose. These two textbook examples of desecration are best understood within the context of the recent student protest at Jantar Mantar.

The protest led by the Cockroach Janta Party (CJP) has sparked a national debate over what is “sacred” and “profane”, and what is “formal” and “informal” in Indian politics. It shows how students can desecrate a “sacred” and “invincible” political force through a measured act of profanation. Interestingly, labelling the movement “profane”, “informal”, or “violent” also serves as the ruling party’s best defence.

Admittedly, a fraction of the students used profanity, slurs and abusive slogans which were directed at the administration out of anger. No one can justify this. However, one must not ignore the instances of profanation in the protest expressed through informality, casualness, and fearlessness, which mainstream media labelled as “anarchism” and the “collapse of political civility”.

### As anti-colonial strategy

Profanation as a mode of serious political intervention is not something new to Indian



M.H. Ilias  
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The recent student protest challenges political power through humour, informality, and profanation

politics. The Indian national movement has, at various times, resorted to such acts as a part of its core political strategy. Instead of violent means, the movement strategically employed non-cooperation, economic boycotts, and public burning of clothes made in England to strip away the authority, prestige and institutional power of the British Raj. In an act tantamount to profanation, some of its leaders publicly renounced awards and honorific titles conferred on them to show that no honours superseded their national sentiments.

Mahatma Gandhi sometimes used satiric language to ridicule the authority. To the question by a reporter about his unimpressive dressing while meeting King George V at Buckingham Palace in 1931, Gandhiji is reported to have remarked, “The king had enough on for both of us.” This was not at all a personal insult or an act of belittlement, but a powerful political statement highlighting the vast disparity in power and wealth between the British colonisers and the Indians, the colonised.

Universally, when conventional means of expression are restricted or suppressed by force, humour, satire, comedy, and trolling fill the vacuum, challenging hegemonic structures in a subtle but more powerful manner. Charlie Chaplin explored this possibility in his 1940 satirical masterpiece, *The Great Dictator*, satirising Hitler’s mannerisms through a character who closely resembled him. More recent examples come from Palestine, where humour serves as a political tool, transforming the daily suffering of Palestinians into a collective form of resistance.

### India’s new politics

In a novel shift, the students function as the agents of profanation in India; they deal with the excessive power of the state by weaponising humour, satire, memes and trolls in ways unheard of. India’s political orthodoxy may refuse to acknowledge that Indian democracy is

equally built through such acts of profanation, not solely through the interventions of formal political institutions. This orthodoxy clearly resonates in media debates, which often write off any form of unconventional politics as either liberal denunciation or left adventurism, completely missing the hopeful cues of a new mode of politics to emerge.

Further, the demand for greater accountability and transparency in governance from the students, a “non-party” political entity, has elicited sceptical responses from across the political spectrum. Much of the concern stems from the movement’s “informal” and “non-institutional” character and its “single-issue” oriented politics. Critics argue that such “street politics” alone does not have the power to bring about radical political transformation.

More optimistically, those on the other side argue that it should remain one of the tactics at our disposal when formal opposition struggles to deliver the desired results. The Congress Party, for instance, does not dismiss the potential of the CJP’s mode of politics, even as it detects and warns of an Aam Aadmi element within it. Congress leader Rahul Gandhi himself occasionally adopts an informal style, engaging directly with people through street-level interventions.

### Rethinking informal politics

The Jantar Mantar protest has definitely offered a radical component for a rethinking of the ways in which informal politics works in India’s democracy. Expressions of dissent in informal forms are often downplayed as subordinate to “popular consensus”, which is measured chiefly through electoral victory. The question of where to place this protest or what basket suits it – whether as an impromptu student mobilisation driven by anger, a street protest with intensive political content, or a sign of an unconventional style of politics – is therefore a significant one.

## LETTERS TO THE EDITOR

### Selective call

Those pushing for the full rendition of *Vande Mataram* should also acknowledge that *Jana Gana Mana* is rendered in its prescribed version rather than in its entirety as a longer composition. *Vande Mataram* and *Jana Gana Mana* have different historical and textual

contexts, and the question of how much of either should be sung should be approached consistently. If the ruling party insists on a full rendition of *Vande Mataram*, why should a similar principle not be considered for the national anthem? **Madhavachar K.**, Bengaluru

### Visit cancelled

The explanation offered by the Ministry of External Affairs (MEA) on the U.S. leg of Telangana Chief Minister A. Revanth Reddy’s overseas tour appears to leave several questions unanswered. The lack of transparency surrounding an important matter concerning the State’s

external economic and investment interests raises legitimate questions. It would appropriate for the Telangana government and the MEA to place the details in the public domain. **M.M. Nagavender Rao**, Hyderabad

**Sowcar Janaki**  
Sowcar Janaki’s portrayal of

women characters of varied hues and shades was astounding. Her verbal sparring with master performer Sivaji Ganesan in *Uyarntha Manithan*, and her stunning performance opposite Gemini Ganesan in *Iru Kodugal*, where she played a District Collector, are unforgettable. The song, *Maalai Pozhudhin*

*Mayakkathile*, brought out the best in Sowcar Janaki in *Bagyalakshmi* (1961). In her production, *Kaviya Thalaivi*, her dual portrayal of mother and daughter was equally outstanding. **S.V. Venugopalan**, Chennai

Letters emailed to letters@thehindu.co.in must carry the postal address.

## *The Jat, non-Jat fault line in Haryana*

## *The rural-urban divide in female labour force participation*

## Wide variations

## Protection of Taj from damage by effluents

## Cricket and entertainment tax



## BJP president holds strategy meeting for Assembly elections

**Press Trust of India**  
NEW DELHI

BJP president Nitin Nabin on Sunday held a meeting with the party's office-bearers to discuss a range of organisational matters, especially the strategy for high-stakes Assembly elections due in seven States next year, including Uttar Pradesh and Gujarat, sources said.

The crucial meeting was attended by the newly appointed office-bearers of the party, presidents of its State units and other key functionaries. Those in-charge of the BJP State units were also present at the meeting held at the BJP headquarters here, according to the sources.

BJP national general secretary (organisation) B.L. Santhosh was also present at the meeting, which delved into measures for strengthening grassroots outreach and youth connect, especially in the States where elections are due next year, the sources said.

There was no official word from the BJP on what transpired in the meeting. Assembly polls are due in Punjab, Uttar Pradesh, Uttarakhand, Goa, Himachal Pradesh and Gujarat



Nitin Nabin

in 2027. The BJP is in power in five of these poll-bound States, except Punjab and Himachal Pradesh. While the Aam Aadmi Party currently rules Punjab, the Congress is in power in Himachal Pradesh.

"It is a crucial meeting to discuss a range of organisational matters with prime focus on the party's preparations and strategy for the upcoming elections in States next year," a source said.

This comes a day after Mr. Nabin held his first meeting with all newly appointed national office-bearers of the party. Former office-bearers of the BJP's national team were also present. Prime Minister Narendra Modi also interacted with the 67 newly-appointed office-bearers of the party.

## Help operationalise women's reservation: Smriti to Rahul

BJP general secretary asks Leader of Opposition to support the PM's initiative on providing 33% reservation for women; she appeals for full rendition of *Vande Mataram* at Cong. headquarters

**The Hindu Bureau**  
NEW DELHI

Bharatiya Janata Party (BJP) general secretary Smriti Irani challenged the Leader of the Opposition in the Lok Sabha Rahul Gandhi to demonstrate his publicly expressed sentiments on women's empowerment by offering support to the government's Bills, which could operationalise the Women's Reservation Act, 2023. Ms. Irani's remarks came after Mr. Gandhi's speech at the Congress's 'Chaatron ki Goonj' (echo of students) event in Pune on Sunday.

Mr. Gandhi had addressed a gathering of mainly women students at the public meeting. He had sharp words for the government's approach on women's empowerment, and the doxxing of women protesters at the Gen Z protests led by the Cockroach Janta Party at Jantar Mantar in the national capital in July.

The Modi government had, in April 2026, brought a Bill for the delimitation of Lok Sabha seats in tandem



BJP national general secretary Smriti Irani during a meeting at the party headquarters in New Delhi on Saturday. PTI

with amendments to the Women's Reservation Act, which would increase seats in the Lower House to 850 based on the 2011 Census, with 33% reservation for women. The Opposition defeated the Constitution amendment Bill, and the Congress Working Committee said that it was in favour of freezing Lok Sabha seats at 543, and 33% reservation for women to be implemented for the 2029 general election.

Ms. Irani, in a statement in New Delhi, spoke of the Bill linking delimitation to reservation for women. "Former national presi-

dent of the Congress party stated at an event that he supports women. Today, I would like to make a request to the former national president. Prime Minister Modi has passed a law providing 33% reservation for women across the country, enabling them to enhance the dignity of the nation's Parliament. Prime Minister Modi has appealed to all political parties to cooperate with him in the swift implementation of this women's reservation law. I humbly ask him to support the Prime Minister's initiative, specifically the swift implementa-

tion of the law providing 33% reservation for women and enabling them to take on leadership roles in Parliament," the former Union Minister said.

**National Song rendition** Ms. Irani added that she was also "aware of" certain remarks made by Mr. Gandhi about the Hindu religion and appealed for the full rendition of *Vande Mataram* at the Congress headquarters.

"I am also aware that remarks regarding the Hindu religion were made at that Congress leader's event yesterday. Given that he has invoked religion, I make one further request to that leader – the lines of *Vande Mataram* that were halted at the Congress headquarters actually contain a reference to Goddess Durga. Regarding Mother Durga, whom we worship as the embodiment of Shakti, the full rendition and singing of *Vande Mataram* should take place at the Congress headquarters. This would reflect the interest and inclination they have shown towards women's issues," she said.

## Haryana Congress leaders seek action against Deepender

**The Hindu Bureau**  
GURUGRAM

Amid a political controversy over Rohtak MP Deepender Singh Hooda's remarks on the late Sajjan Kumar, senior Haryana Congress leaders have sought action against him, saying that his comments could hurt the party's prospects among the Sikh community.

Mr. Hooda, meanwhile, issued a video statement on Sunday expressing regret over the controversy and said his earlier remarks had been distorted. He clarified that he had not described Kumar as a "role model", adding that never intended to hurt the sentiments of the Sikh community.

**'Immature remarks'** Former Haryana Assembly Speaker Kuldeep Sharma has written to Congress president Mallikarjun Kharge seeking Mr. Hooda's removal as a permanent invitee to the Congress Working Committee. Describing the remarks as "immature" and "irresponsible", Mr. Sharma said such statements were particularly damaging at a time when Punjab is heading towards Assembly election.

Mr. Sharma told *The Hindu* that Sikh voters had supported the Congress in the 2024 Lok Sabha election despite the party's alleged association with the legacy of the 1984 anti-Sikh riots.

"Punjab elections are at our threshold. Such an irresponsible statement is going to harm the pros-



Deepender Singh Hooda

pects of the party in Punjab," he said, adding that instead of assuaging the feelings of Sikhs, a party leader had made comments in support of Kumar.

Sajjan Kumar, a former Congress leader, was convicted in a 1984 anti-Sikh riots case. His death three days ago triggered Mr. Hooda's remarks, in which he described Kumar as a prominent political figure whose connect with people was an example for others to follow.

Congress leader Shamsher Singh Gogi, said such remarks reopened the wounds of families affected by the 1984 anti-Sikh violence and undermined the Congress's efforts to rebuild its relationship with the Sikh community.

**BJP slams Congress** Haryana BJP president Archana Gupta criticised the Congress over the controversy. In a post on Facebook, she said the memories of the 1984 violence remained alive among thousands of Sikh families and demanded that the Congress leadership clarify what action it would take against Mr. Hooda.

## Bengal govt. appoints BJP legislators to lead college bodies

**Shiv Sahay Singh**  
KOLKATA

The Bharatiya Janata Party (BJP) government in West Bengal has appointed MLAs and MPs belonging to the party as presidents of governing bodies in more than 200 government-aided colleges across the State.

The Suwendu Adhikari government, after coming to power in Bengal in early May, had dissolved the governing bodies that were helmed by legislators from the Trinamool Congress.

A notification issued by the West Bengal Higher Education Department pointed out that president of college governing body have been appointed for 247 State-run colleges.

Some of the BJP leaders appointed to head college governing bodies include Health Minister Sharadwat Mukherjee, who has been appointed president of the governing body of East Kolkata Girls College, and Minister of State for Fire Services Kaushik Chowdhury, who has been appointed head of the managing com-

**Suwendu Adhikari had promised to make educational institutions free of politics**

mittee of Raiganj B.Ed. College. Union Minister of State and Balurghat MP Sukanta Majumdar has been made president of the governing body of Balurghat College, while the Speaker of West Bengal Assembly, Rathindra Bose, has been made the president of Coochbehar College.

State Higher Education Minister Jagannath Chattopadhyay said there was nothing unusual in these appointments. The Minister said that those who have a Bachelor's degree have been made presidents of college governing bodies.

**'Free of politics'** "Local MLAs and MPs are members of the college management committee ex officio. In that case, those who have a Bachelor's degree have been made presidents. This go-

vernment will not allow the educational field to become a playground for politics in any way," the Minister said.

After coming to power in West Bengal, Chief Minister Suwendu Adhikari had promised to make educational institutions free of politics. "We have cancelled the political nominations that were in various schools, colleges and universities with the aim of making educational institutions free from political influence. Because, making educational insti-

tutions free from politics and giving autonomy to universities – these should be our priorities," the Chief Minister had said.

Political observers see the move of appointing BJP MLAs and MPs as president of college governing bodies as a departure from what the BJP had promised. The culture of having politicians at the helm of State-run colleges had been prevalent during the Left Front regime and there was no exception to this in the Trinamool Congress regime.

## CJP to review status of Centre's assurances; to keep options 'open'

**Press Trust of India**  
NEW DELHI

The Cockroach Janta Party (CJP) will convene a meeting of its national working committee on Monday to review the status of the commitments made by the Centre following the withdrawal of its nationwide agitation on July 25. The outfit stated that the government is yet to for-

mally communicate the steps being taken to fulfil the assurances.

The CJP said it will consider all steps to secure fulfilment of the commitments, including the possibility of launching another peaceful nationwide agitation.

"The CJP called off its agitation in good faith because the government gave its word to the young peo-

ple of this country," it said, adding that it would not allow that "good faith" to be mistaken for "weakness".

This comes days after the Supreme Court sought a consolidated list of FIRs registered against students and protesters across the country on August 18. "Despite the court repeatedly asking for this list, the Centre did not commit to providing it," the CJP said.

**Uttarakhand Tourism Development Board (UTDB)**  
Pt. Deendayal Upadhyay Paryatan Bhawan,  
Near O.N.G.C. Heli-pad, Nimbuwala, Garhi Cantt, Dehradun – 248003 (UK),  
**Ph. 91-135-2559898, Fax, 91-135-2559888**

**Ref. No: 3002/2-7-1035/2026-27** **Dated: 22/08/2026**

**SELECTION OF A TRAINING AGENCY FOR OUTDOOR EDUCATION, WILDERNESS MEDICINE & GUIDE CAPACITY BUILDING**

Details may be obtained on website: **uktenders.gov.in** from 3:00 PM on 24.08.2026. **Pre-bid meeting will be held at 12:30 PM on 31.08.2026.** Prospective Bidders may seek clarification till 3:00 PM on 29.08.2026 through E-mail: **adventurewingutdb@gmail.com** with CC to **procurement.utdb@gmail.com**. Any Addendum / Corrigendum including date extension will be uploaded on **uktenders.gov.in**. Proposals must be submitted online through **uktenders.gov.in** only. The last date for submission of proposals is 14.09.2026 till 3:00 PM.

**Chief Executive Officer**

**कोल इंडिया लिमिटेड**  
(एक महारण कंपनी)

"All the tenders issued by CIL and its Subsidiaries for procurement of Goods, Works and Services are available on website of Coal India Ltd **www.coalindia.in** / respective Subsidiary Company, CIL e-procurement portal **https://coalindiatenders.nic.in** and Central Procurement Portal **https://eprocure.gov.in** In addition, procurement is also done through GeM portal **https://gem.gov.in**".

**REQUEST FOR PROPOSAL (RFP)**

**RFP No. 251/2026**

Proposals are invited for "Selection of a Co-Developer to Develop, Build and Operate a Mixed Use Facility in Technopark Phase I Campus, Thiruvananthapuram, Kerala".

The last date of submission of RFP is **23.09.2026**.

For further details, please visit **https://www.technopark.in/tenders**

**Date: 21-08-2026** **Chief Executive Officer**  
**Trivandrum** **D3/498/2026/I&PRD** **Technopark**

**GOVERNMENT OF INDIA – DEPARTMENT OF SPACE CONSTRUCTION & MAINTENANCE GROUP, SDSC – SHAR SRIHARIKOTA – 524124**

**Brief E-TENDER NOTICE**

No: SHAR: CMG CIVIL:MAINT:E-PT-08/26-27 **Dt: 21.08.2026**

On behalf of President of India, Item Rate tenders are invited through e-tendering for following works;

| Name of Work                                                                                              | Tender No  | Estimate Cost |
|-----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|------------|---------------|
| Term Contract for Civil works @ KRP(PCN) Colony, Sullurupeta.                                             | T/C-26-016 | ₹ 80 Lakhs    |
| Term Contract for Civil works @ SMN & PNN Colonies, Sullurupeta.                                          | T/C-26-017 | ₹ 80 Lakhs    |
| Term Contract for Painting works of facility buildings and residential quarters for one year @ SDSC SHAR. | T/C-26-018 | ₹ 75 Lakhs    |

Tender documents can be downloaded up to 07.09.2026, 14:30 hrs. For eligibility criteria and other details, interested tenderers may please refer to the detailed bilingual (Hindi-English) Notice Inviting Tenders (NIT) on the website **https://www.isro.gov.in/Tenders.html** and tender free view at **https://www.tenderwizard.com/isro**

**Sd/- GROUP HEAD, CMG/SDSC SHAR**

**THE TAMIL NADU COOPERATIVE MILK PRODUCERS' FEDERATION LIMITED**  
THE JOINT MANAGING DIRECTOR, No. 29 & 30 Ambattur industrial estate, Ambattur, Chennai-600098, Phone 044-23464528/30/31/32 E-Mail aavinpt@gmail.com

**Ref. No. 177/IRMT/TP/2026** **Date : 21.08.2026**

**NOTICE INVITING TENDER (e-Submission)**  
(Only through e-Procurement Portal at **www.tntenders.gov.in**)

The TCMPF Ltd. Invites TWO PART TENDERS by way of e-Submission through e-Procurement Portal from Private tanker providers/Contractors for following contract works.

| Sl.No. | Name of the Items/work                                                                                                                                  | EMD (In Rs.) |
|--------|---------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|--------------|
| 1      | Hiring of 9 KL, 15 KL, 20 KL and 30 KL capacity Road Milk Tankers on Contract for 3 years for Transportation of Milk with & outside State of Tamil Nadu | Rs. 20,000/- |

Tender document Availability The tender document can be downloaded from website e-Procurement Portal **https://tntenders.gov.in** from **28.08.2026 to 30.09.2026** upto 3.00 PM

Date & Time of Pre-Bid meeting **10.09.2026 at 11.00 AM**

Date & Time of closing of e-Submission of Technical Bid and Financial Bid **30.09.2026 upto 3.00 PM**

Date & Time of Opening of Part 1 Technical Bid of e-Tender The Technical Bids shall be opened through online e-Procurement Portal **https://tntenders.gov.in** on following date at above mentioned address **01.10.2026 at 11.30 AM**

The tenderer should submit their bids only through e-Procurement Portal **https://tntenders.gov.in**. All other details can be seen in the tender documents. Corrigendum/Addendum to this publication, if any would appear only on the above said website..

**JOINT MANAGING DIRECTOR**  
**The Tamilnadu Co-op. Milk Producers' Fedn. Ltd.,**

**DIPR / 2648 / TENDER /2026**

**TAMILNADU MEDICAL SERVICES CORPORATION LIMITED**  
(A Government of Tamilnadu Undertaking)  
No. 417, Pantheon Road, Egmore, Chennai - 600008.  
Phone: 044-2819 1890, 2819 0259 **Website: www.tnmsc.tn.gov.in**  
E-Mail: **gmdrug.tnmsc@tn.gov.in, mngdrug.tnmsc@tn.gov.in**

Online Tender is invited by the Tender Inviting Authority, Tamilnadu Medical Services Corporation Ltd., Chennai – 600008, from Licensed **Drugs and Medicines** Manufacturers having three years Market Standing and holding Good Manufacturing Practice Certificate (as per latest revised Schedule "M" of D&C Act, 1940) issued by the Drugs Control Authority. Direct Importers holding a valid Import License and experienced for a minimum period of three years and Loan Licensees having valid Loan License are also eligible to participate in this tender.

| Sl. No | Description                                                                                                                                     | e-Tender Reference                                    | Tender Floating Period                           | e-Tender Submission Duration                      | Date and time of online opening of Technical Bids |
|--------|-------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|-------------------------------------------------------|--------------------------------------------------|---------------------------------------------------|---------------------------------------------------|
| 1      | Online Re-Tender for the supply of <b>Speciality Drugs</b> to TNMSC Limited under rate contract system for one year from the date of acceptance | e-020(M/P)/RE-SPLDRUGS/ TNMSC/2026, Dated, 24.08.2026 | 24.08.2026 at 4.00 PM to 23.09.2026 upto 3.00 PM | 31.08.2026 at 10.00 AM to 23.09.2026 upto 3.00 PM | 23.09.2026 at 4.00 PM                             |

The tender document can be downloaded and the tender shall be submitted at **https://tntenders.gov.in/**. The tender document can also be downloaded at **www.tnmsc.tn.gov.in** for reference purpose.

**DIPR/ 2614 /Tender/2026** **Tender Inviting Authority / General Manager (Drugs)**

CM  
YK

# MONEYWISE

## Israeli strikes kill three, including four-year-old child, in Gaza strip



# Chinese humanoid robot breaks Usain Bolt's 100m world record



## Kuwait approves decree stripping naturalised citizens of their vote



## Indonesian police arrest 72 people suspected of starting forest fires



# New sanctions a sign of 'desperation', U.S. measures will fail, says Araghchi

# Escalating tariff trade war 'devastating' for Canada: U.S. official

# On battle anniversary, Taiwan leader vows 'never to yield an inch' to China

# DR Congo and M23 fighters agree to road map for peace talks

# Sport

# Deshpande and Kotian put West in control

# Starc reality for Bangladesh

**The scores:** Bangladesh 64 & 95 in 38.3 overs (Starc 4/39, Cummins 3/10, Lyon 3/25) lost to Australia 210 in 52.3 overs (Smith 42, Green 67, Shoriful 7/48);  
**PoM & PoS:** Starc.

## Kotak and van Niekerk attribute Jaiswal-Asitha skirmish to impulse



AFP

## 'Kuldeep had a viral infection and wasn't available for selection'



ANI

## 'Asitha showed he could continue to threaten and take wickets'



PTI

## India leg-spinner Karn announces retirement from all formats



FILE PHOTO: K. MURALI KUMAR

# Padikkal makes scoring centuries a habit as India touches 300

## It is time for our all-rounders and lower-order to score: Kotak

# India eliminated after a goalless draw with Australia

# Man City rallies past Bournemouth

# Man City rallies past Bournemouth

Newcastle 2 (Elanga 5, Willock 5)  
drew with Liverpool 2 (Gakpo 55,  
Szoboszlai 90+9-pen).

**LaLiga:** Atletico Madrid 2 (Pubill  
59, Simeone 85) drew with  
Villarreal 2 (Moreno 66-pen,  
Mikuatadze 78-pen).

**On Saturday: Premier League:**  
Brentford 3 (Lewis-Potter 12,  
Janelt 33, Kayode 49) bt  
Tottenham 0.

**Serie A:** Inter Milan 4 (Calhanoglu  
6, Zielinski 48, Monza 55,  
Bisseck 63) bt Espoza 1 (Varela 29);  
Udinese 1 (Kamara 29) drew with  
Como 1 (Douvikas 54); Genoa 0  
lost to Napoli 2 (De Bruyne 82,  
Vergara 87).

**LaLiga:** Athletic Bilbao 1 (Paredes  
70) lost to Sevilla 3 (Oso 15, Ejuke  
50, Romero 57); Valencia 0 drew  
with Celta Vigo 0; Espanyol 1  
(Calatrava 30) lost to Real Madrid  
2 (Bellingham 9, Espi 90).

# Dominant Lanier and Se-young power their way to the top

The 21-year-old becomes the first French men's singles champion; compatriots Gicquel and Delrue make it a double delight by winning the mixed doubles title; Keng and Chang bag the men's doubles crown, China's only gold in the tournament

**BADMINTON WORLDS**  
**Uthra Ganesan**  
NEW DELHI

Alex Lanier walked into history books and An Se-young asserted her supremacy after being crowned World champions in style at the 2026 World badminton championships here on Sunday.

Lanier, at 21, became the first French men's singles champion with a clinical, one-sided 21-11, 21-11 dismantling of Japan's Kodai Naraoka in the final to make it a double delight for the French.

The mixed doubles pair of Thom Gicquel and Delphine Delrue became the first-ever French champions in the morning, defeating the top-ranked Chinese pair of Feng Yan Zhe and Huang Dong Ping 22-20, 19-21, 21-15. Top-ranked Se-young, meanwhile, extended her winning streak against World No. 2 and defending champion Akane



**Soaring high:** Lanier's clinical performance proved too much for Naraoka. SHIV KUMAR PUSHPAKAR

Yamaguchi to six matches in their 35th encounter with a 21-17, 21-14 victory to regain the title.

The 10th-ranked Lanier was all over Naraoka for a large part of the final, never letting the Japanese set-

tle. The two were circumspect early on, probing, lifting and dropping tentatively rather than going all-out on the attack.

**Shifting gears**  
Leading 11-9 in the opening game, Lanier shifted gears, becoming more aggressive and forcing Naraoka into errors to clinch the game 21-11.

The second stanza witnessed more of the same as Naraoka tried everything but was unable to find any gaps in Lanier's defence or repel his smashes.

From 14-11, Lanier raced through the next seven points to seal the deal.

The women's final was on expected lines and saw high intensity, high speed action.

The opening game was close with the lead exchanging hands regularly.

Se-young was ahead 15-12 but Yamaguchi won four straight points to move to 16-15. However, the Korean went on to win 21-17.

The second game followed a similar pattern. Ya-

maguchi went ahead early before Se-young hit a couple of winners to go up 11-7.

A combination of unforced errors and missed chances from the Japanese saw the top-ranked player jump to a 17-13 lead before wrapping up the win.

**Second Korean duo**  
In women's doubles, Baek Ha Na and Lee So Hee beat top seeds Sheng Shu Liu and Ning Tan 21-15, 21-15 to become only the second Korean champions in the event after a gap of 31 years, the last being Gil Young-ah and Jang Hye-ock in 1995.

**The results (finals):**  
**Men:** Alex Lanier (Fra) bt Kodai Naraoka (Jpn) 21-11, 21-11.  
**Doubles:** Liang Wei Keng & Wang Chang (Chn) bt Aaron Chia & Soh Wooi Yik (Mas) 21-17, 21-16.  
**Women:** An Se-young (Kor) bt Akane Yamaguchi (Jpn) 21-17, 21-14.  
**Doubles:** Baek Ha Na & Lee So Hee (Kor) bt Sheng Shu Liu & Ning Tan (Chn) 21-15, 21-15.  
**Mixed doubles:** Thom Gicquel & Delphine Delrue (Fra) bt Feng Yan Zhe & Huang Dong Ping (Chn) 22-20, 19-21, 21-15.



**Surreal:** Gayatri and Treesa gave India its first women's doubles medal since 2011. SHIV KUMAR PUSHPAKAR

## Treesa-Gayatri pair cherishes medal

**Devyanshi Bihani**  
NEW DELHI

The Indian flag rose at the Indra Gandhi Indoor Stadium on Sunday as Treesa Jolly and Gayatri Gopichand received their World championships bronze, bringing a ceremonial close to a week in which they gave India's first women's doubles medal since 2011.

"We'll cherish this medal forever," Gayatri said. The unseeded pair lost to China's Liu-Tan in the semifinal after beating reigning Olympic champion Jia Yifan and her partner Zhang Shuxian in the quarterfinals.

"We were just so happy after the quarterfinal match. And even in the semifinal, we gave 100%. It just wasn't our day," Gayatri said.

For coach Pullela Gopi Chand, the medal reflected six weeks of work paying off. "It's good to see when the practice you do actually gives you dividends on court," he said on Saturday.

After an injury-hit period that raised questions about their ability to perform at this level, Treesa said their results provided the answer: "We both were here to do something big. What we can show is our result. I think we did that."

They now turn towards the Asian Games, with the Chinese pair still on their minds.

"It's obviously a matter of time. Just believe in yourself that you can beat them," Treesa said.

## Karthik is perfect fit to coach CSK, says Hayden

**Aashin Prasad**  
AMSTELVEEN

Former Australian cricketer Matthew Hayden feels that the Chennai-based Dinesh Karthik is a "perfect" candidate to take over as Chennai Super Kings head coach.

Karthik, who is serving as the batting coach and mentor of Royal Challengers Bengaluru, has been instrumental in the two-time defending IPL champion's success.

"It's something that I really hope the franchise gets right. Flemo did a fantastic job with M.S. Dhoni, that was such a strong engine room of CSK," Hayden told *The Hindu*.

Hayden, the co-owner and head coach of Glasgow Cosmic in the European T20 Premier League, believes that Karthik is ready to take up the role at CSK.

"I think it's important to have a local coach. I know that a lot of franchises go for international coaches, but I feel the head coach role of a franchise as big as CSK should have that kind of local touch, even Chennai touch, which is why Karthik would be perfect".

# Qualifier 1 called off due to rain; Panthers reach final

**TNPL**  
**S. Dipak Ragav**  
CHENNAI

The start of the business end of TNPL-10 turned out to be a damp squib as rain played spoilsport in the Qualifier 1 clash between Madurai Panthers and Trichy Grand Cholas. The game was abandoned after two interruptions at the M.A. Chidambaram Stadium here on Sunday.

The 2018 champion booked its place in the summit clash to be held on Friday, thanks to its top-of-the-table finish.

Though both sides earned 10 points in the league stage, Panthers had a better Net Run Rate (0.548) compared to Grand Cholas' 0.095.

In this context, Panthers' thumping 72-run win over Nellai Royal Kings in its last league match on Saturday helped the B. Anirudh Sita Ram-led outfit leapfrog Grand Cholas in the standings.

Earlier on Sunday evening, the Madurai team opted to field, and only 2.5 overs were possible before rain stopped the proceedings with Grand Cholas at 25 for one.



**A strike and a storm:** Suresh Kumar was castled by Gurjapneet before the heavens opened up. R. RAGU

Play resumed two hours later, and after just two more overs, the heavens opened up again to bring the curtains down for the night.

**The scores:** Trichy Grand Cholas 49/1 in 4.5 overs (K. Rajkumar 38 n.o.) vs. Madurai Panthers.

**Monday's match (Eliminator):** Vida Kovai Kings vs. iDream Tiruppur Tamizhans (7.30 p.m.).

# One N Only obliges in the main event

HYDERABAD: Trainer D. Netto's ward One N Only, ridden by Akshay Kumar, won the Governor's Trophy, the feature event of Sunday's races here.

The winner is owned by M/s. Rama Seshu Eyyunni, Shankar Srinivas, Ashok Ranpise & Donald Anthony Netto. Akshay Kumar stole the limelight by riding to four victories while Trainer D. Netto saddled three winners.

**1. HIDDEN BLOOM PLATE (DIV. I) (1,400M):** CORINTHIAN (Akshay Kumar) 1, Ragnarök (Shivam) 2, Decoy (Mukesh K) 3 and Dali's Destiny (Gaurav) 4. 1/2, 3 and 3/4. Im, 25.78s. ₹15 (w), 10, 31 and 20 (p). SHP: 99, THP: 39, FP: 137, Q: 115. Tanala: 2THP. Favourite: Corinthian. Owner: Mr. C. Aryama Sundaram. Trainer: D. Netto.

**2. SILVER PHANTOM PLATE (1,400M):** YOU TUBER (Akshay Kumar) 1, Ashwa Jaffna (Gaurav) 2, French Lieutenant (P. Ajeeth K) 3 and Belgium Waffle (Mohit) 4. 2-1/2, Head and 1. Im, 26.28s. ₹30 (w), 18, 22 and 10 (p). SHP: 59, THP: 67, FP: 162, Q: 148, Tanala: 510. Favourite: French Lieutenant. Owners: Mr. M. Raghunath rep. Gava Racing Syndicate LLP & Mr. P. Amarendra Reddy. Trainer: K. Satheesh.

**3. RUSSIAN SAGAR TROPHY (1,600M):** PRIDE ASIDE (Imran Chisty) 1, Hopping High (Mohit) 2,

Quintessential (P. Ajeeth K) 3 and Bartolino (A.A. Vikram) 4. 3, 1-1/4 and 9-1/4. Im, 41.63s. ₹29 (w), 10, 17 and 10 (p). SHP: 28, THP: 41, FP: 168, Q: 102, Tanala: 369. Favourite: Quintessential.

**4. HIDDEN BLOOM PLATE (DIV. II) (1,400M):** KNIGHT CRUSADER (B.R. Kumar) 1, Annihilator (Mukesh K) 2, Victoria Doesaani (Akshay K) 3 and Certainty (T.S. Jodha) 4. 1/2, 1/2 and 2. Im, 27.70s. ₹41 (w), 11, 15 and 13 (p). SHP: 61, THP: 35, FP: 224, Q: 201, Tanala: 723. Favourite: Victoria Doesaani.

**5. RED RUN PLATE (1,100M):** ZORBA (P. Ajeeth Kumar) 1, Anemara (Akshay K) 2, Khamagani (B. Nikhil) 3 and Trend Setter (I. Chisty) 4. Short Head, 1/2 and Nose. Im, 8.76s. ₹64 (w), 17, 16 and 31 (p). SHP: 37, THP: 97, FP: 233, Q: 70, Tanala: 3. 084. Favourite: Anemara. Owners: Col. S.B. Nair & Mr. Aditya P. Thackersey. Trainer: L.V.R. Deshmukh.

**6. GOVERNOR'S TROPHY (1,200M):** ONE N ONLY (Akshay Kumar) 1, Timeless Vision (T.S. Jodha) 2, Diablo (P. Sai KJ) 3 and D Minchu (B.R. Kumar) 4. Not run: Vivaldo. 1-1/4, 3 and 1/2. Im, 13.76s. ₹20 (w), 10, 16 and 10 (p). SHP: 44, THP: 31,

FP: 75, Q: 40, Tanala: 105. Favourite: One N Only. Owners: M/s. Rama Seshu Eyyunni, Shankar Srinivas, Ashok Ranpise & Donald Anthony Netto. Trainer: D. Netto.

**7. FAIR HAVEN PLATE (1,200M):** HANUMANMAHABALA (Neeraj Rawal) 1, Screenshot (Arjun) 2, Red Hot Punch (P. Ajeeth K) 3 and Aditya (Rafique Sk.) 4. Dist, 1 and Neck. Im, 14.36s. ₹17 (w), 12, 53 and 14 (p). SHP: 85, THP: 47, FP: 230, Q: 178, Tanala: 1,458. Favourite: Hanumanmahabala. Owners: M/s. Balam Mohla, Kishore M. Dingra, Vara Prasad Reddy & Sultan Singh. Trainer: Neellesh Rawal.

**8. KARIMNAGAR PLATE (1,400M):** DINO (Akshay Kumar) 1, Zindabad (Mukesh K) 2, Valledonna (P. Ajeeth K) 3 and Sugriva (Arjun) 4. 6-1/2, Neck and 1/2. Im, 29.14s. ₹26 (w), 11, 15 and 34 (p). SHP: 45, THP: 59, FP: 65, Q: 43, Tanala: 466. Favourite: Dino.

Owners: M/s. Rama Seshu Eyyunni, Prabhakar Chowdary Vipuraneni & Srikanth Badruka. Trainer: D. Netto. *NOTE: La Quinta (P. Sai K) up) dislodged the rider soon after the start.*

Jackpot: 70%: ₹5,968 (95 tkts.) & 30%: 740 (328 tkts.).

Mini Jackpot (Q) 9,953 (21 tkts.), (ii) 1,420 (82 tkts.).

Treble: (i) 180 (177 tkts.), (ii) 1,660 (31 tkts.), (iii) 154 (342 tkts.).

## SNAPSHOTS

**Norris retains the Dutch GP crown**  
ZANDVOORT: Defending champion Lando Norris gave McLaren a third successive Dutch GP victory on Sunday in a race of shifting fortunes that had to be re-started after home hero Max Verstappen crashed on the opening lap. Championship leader Kimi Antonelli finished second with teammate George Russell obeying orders to let the Italian through late in the race and then holding off Ferrari's Lewis Hamilton for third.

**The results:**  
1. Lando Norris (McLaren) 2h:4m:44.859s (McLaren); 2. Kimi Antonelli (Mercedes) +11.536s; 3. George Russell (Mercedes) 15.906; 4. Lewis Hamilton (Ferrari) 16.755; 5. Charles Leclerc (Ferrari) 17.258; 6. Oscar Piastri (McLaren) 32.332; 7. Liam Lawson (Red Bull) 1:19.915; +1 lap: 8. Nico Hulkenberg (Audi); 9. Fernando Alonso (Aston Martin); 10. Pierre Gasly (Alpine); 11. Yuki Tsunoda (Racing Bulls); 12. Arvid Lindblad (Racing Bulls); 13. Gabriel Bortoleto (Audi). **+2 laps:** 14. Franco Colapinto (Alpine); 15. Sergio Perez (Cadillac); 16. Carlos Sainz (Williams). **DNF:** 17. Alex Albon (Williams); 18. Valtteri Bottas (Cadillac); 19. Esteban Ocon (Haas); 20. Lance Stroll (Aston Martin); 21. Oliver Bearman (Haas); 22. Max Verstappen (Red Bull). **Standings: Drivers:** 1. Antonelli 242; 2. Russell 183; 3. Hamilton 183; 4. Norris 159; 5. Leclerc 155. **Constructors:** 1. Mercedes 425; 2. Ferrari 338; 3. McLaren 263; 4. Red Bull 186; 5. Racing Bulls 66.

**Lalrindika's hat-trick fires East Bengal to Durand Cup glory**  
KOLKATA: East Bengal FC swept past arch-rival Mohun Bagan Super Giant 4-1 in the 135th Durand Cup final to reclaim the trophy after a 22-year wait. Edmund Lalrindika was the star of the show, scoring a memorable hat-trick and turning the Kolkata derby into a one-sided affair. Bipin Singh, too, found the net for EBFC while Manvir Singh scored for Bagan. **The result: Final:** East Bengal FC 4 (Bipin Singh 10, Edmund Lalrindika 11, 22, 44) bt Mohun Bagan SG 1 (Manvir Singh 33). **— Amitabha Das Sharma**

**Double delight for birthday girl Syndreia; Payas claims men's title**  
KANPUR: Syndreia Das marked her 17th birthday



Norris. AP



**The titlists:** Om, left, and Deepshika, right. SPECIAL ARRANGEMENT

in style, claiming a double crown, while Payas Jain bounced back from the disappointment of losing the Commonwealth Championship final three weeks ago to headline the final day of the UTT National-ranking table tennis tournament on Sunday.

In the youth boys' final, Priyanuj Bhattacharyya edged Abhinandh P.B. in a 65-minute thriller. Despite conceding the fifth-game tie-break 21-23, Priyanuj responded with an aggressive approach to pocket the next two games and seal the title.

**The results: Men: Final:** Payas Jain (Del) bt Manav Thakkar (PSPB) 11-3, 9-11, 11-5, 12-10, 11-8. **Semifinals:** Payas bt Jeet Chandra (RSPB) 11-8, 11-5, 11-8, 1-11, 11-7; Manav bt Ankur Bhattacharjee (Har) 12-10, 13-11, 11-9, 9-11, 11-8.

**Women: Final:** Syndreia Das (WB) bt Divyanshi Bhowmick (Mah) 9-11, 11-8, 11-8, 5-11, 11-7, 11-9. **Semifinals:** Divyanshi bt Yashaswini Ghorpade (PSPB) 11-4, 11-6, 11-4, 9-11, 11-2; Syndreia bt Swastika Ghosh (PSPB) 11-9, 5-11, 11-8, 8-11, 11-8, 8-11, 11-9.

**Youth (U-19): Boys: Final:** Priyanuj Bhattacharyya (RSPB) bt Abhinandh P.B. (TN) 9-11, 11-5, 11-3, 8-11, 21-23, 11-4, 11-7. **Semifinals:** Priyanuj bt Punit Biswas (WB) 11-7, 11-5, 11-3; Abhinandh bt Soham Mukherjee (WB) 12-10, 12-10, 11-9. **Girls: Final:** Syndreia bt Ananya Muralidharan (TN) 11-8, 10-12, 11-9, 11-9, 11-4. **Semifinals:** Syndreia bt Naisha Rewaskar (Mah) 8-11, 11-9, 11-7, 11-7; Ananya bt Divyanshi Bhowmick (Mah) 11-5, 2-11, 11-7, 11-7. **— Amol Karhadkar**

**Haryana triumphs**  
PUNE: Haryana defeated Jharkhand 2-1 in the Division 'A' final of the 16th Hockey India junior women's National hockey championship on Sunday. **The result:** Haryana 2 (Bhavya 23, Khushi 42) bt Jharkhand 1 (Mundri Saroj 19).

**Teenagers Saishiva and Bhuvan sizzle**  
CHENNAI: Teenagers Saishiva Sankaran and Bhuvan Bonu starred in the opening round of the MRF Indian National Racing Challenge 4W at the Madras International Circuit (MIC) on Sunday. **The results (provisional, all 10 laps unless mentioned):**  
**MRF Formula 2000: Race-2:** 1. Saishiva Sankaran 20:11.403s; 2. Aditya Patnaik 20:13.709; 3. Krishay Gutte 20:15.857; **Race-3:** 1. Saishiva (16:22.565); 2. Aditya (16:27.649); 3. Swarnav Das 16:33.095.  
**MRF Formula 1600: Race-2:** 1. Bhuvan Bonu 21:19.141; 2. Evan Shrawan 21:47.811; **Race-3:** 1. Bhuvan (18:10.216); 2. Gyan Satish 16:22.952+1 lap; 3. Shivansh Bejoy 16:34.435+1 lap.  
**Indian Super Touring Cars: Race-1:** 1. Ritesh Rai (Buzzing Hornet Motorsports) 19:01.310; 2. Aman Nagdev (Buzzing Hornet Motorsports) 19:15.179; 3. Jeet Jhabakh (Buzzing Hornet Motorsports) 19:23.583; **Race-2:** 1. Ritesh (19:05.125); 2. Aman (19:18.370); 3. Jeet (19:23.919).



**One for the album:** The winners of the Southern Slam squash tournament. SPECIAL ARRANGEMENT



MRF F2000 winner Saishiva.

**Super Stock: Race-1:** 1. T.S. Diljith (DTS Racing) 20:58.700; 2. Deepa S. John (DTS Racing) 19:02.465+1 lap; 3. Lal Kittikulam Bharathan (DTS Racing) 19:07.680+1 lap; **Race-2:** 1. Diljith (20:58.700); 2. Bharathan (21:03.047); 3. Deepa (19:21.307+1 lap). **Volkswagen Polo Cup: Race-1:** 1. Pratik Sonawane 19:38.049; 2. Neel Shah 19:40.454; 3. Hitarth Bhatt 19:43.247; **Race-2:** 1. Sonawane (19:39.604); 2. Neel (19:55.514); 3. Balaji Raju 20:00.495.  
**Formula LGB 1300: Race-2: Open:** 1. Viswas Vijayaraj (DTS Racing) 22:21.644; 2. Vinithkumar (DTS Racing) 22:24.307; 3. Liron Jaden Samuels (DTS Racing) 22:27.640. **Junior:** 1. Kaveen Diyaan Rajapaksa (Momentum Motorsports) 22:41.719; 2. Abhijit Vadavalli (Momentum Motorsports) 22:51.719; 3. Aadam Junaid (Momentum Motorsports) 22:54.102. **Race-3: Open, 7 laps:** 1. Viswas (13:15.418); 2. Liron (13:23.756); 3. Vinithkumar (13:24.135). **Junior, 7 laps:** 1. Rajapaksa (13:36.878); 2. Shatveer (Meco Racing) 13:43.726; 3. Yash (Delta Speeds) 13:51.885.

**Rahul and Rathika win titles**  
Rahul Baitha and Rathika Seelan emerged the men's and women's champion, respectively, in the Southern Slam squash at the Indian Squash Academy on Saturday. In the boys' under-17 final, Lokesh Subramani edged out Shreyansh Jha 11-8, 11-1, 8-11, 8-11, 11-7.

**Other results (finals; Indians unless specified): Men:** Rahul Baitha bt Gurveer Singh 11-3,

13-11, 11-8; **Women:** Rathika Seelan bt R. Pooja Arthi 11-4, 11-9, 11-3.  
**Boys: U-19:** Purav Rambhika bt Shravin Jain 11-5, 11-4, 8-11, 11-4; **U-15:** Dhruv Johri bt Fareed Andrabi 11-8, 4-11, 11-5, 11-2; **U-13:** Kaelen Evan Low (Sgp) bt Ridaan Gupta 11-2, 11-7, 11-5; **U-11:** Yuchen Mason Han (Sgp) bt Vedant Shinde 11-7, 11-7, 11-9. **Girls: U-19:** Akanksha Gupta bt Eesha Shrivastava 11-8, 11-5, 11-3; **U-17:** Yushan Jacintha Han (Sgp) bt Aarika Mishra 11-9, 11-4, 12-10; **U-15:** M. Goushika bt Diva Parasrampuria 11-6, 9-11, 11-7, 12-10; **U-13:** Keerti Bala (Mas) bt Riyaa Dalal 11-7, 6-11, 12-10, 11-6; u-11: Meera Ruthiran (Mas) bt Gaurvi Ajmera 11-3, 11-8, 11-8.

**Om Patel, Deepshika emerge champions**  
Om Patel rallied to beat Om Verma 1-6, 6-3, 6-1 in the final and clinched the boys' title in the UNIFI-ITF Junior Tennis Cup at the SDAT tennis stadium in Nungambakkam on Saturday. Reigning junior National champion Deepshika Vinayagamurthy defeated Savitha Bhuvaneshwaran 6-4, 6-3 for the girls' title.

**LIVE TELECAST**  
**Duleep Trophy:** Quarterfinals, Day 2, JioHotstar, 9.30 a.m.  
**Sri Lanka vs India:** Second Test, Day 2, Sony Sports Ten 1 & LIV, 10 a.m.  
**Hockey World Cup:** (Men) SS Select 2, Star Sports First & JioHotstar, 1 p.m. 4; Argentina vs India, 6.15 p.m. & 9.30 p.m. (Women): SS Select 2, Star Sports First & JioHotstar, 2.30 p.m., 5.30, 8.30 p.m. & 12 a.m. (Tuesday)  
**TNPL:** Sony Sports Ten 4 & TNPL Official YouTube channel (youtube.com/tamilnadupremier-league.com), 7.30 p.m.  
**Serie A:** Unit8 Sports 1, 2 & Z5 App, 10 p.m. & 12.15 a.m. (Tuesday)  
**LaLiga:** FanCode, 11 p.m. & 1 a.m. (Tuesday)  
**Premier League:** SS Select 1 & JioHotstar, 12.30 a.m. (Tuesday).

# When two is too few

Given that the World Test Championship has been in vogue since 2019 and there is no compulsion for teams to play more than two Tests, commercial considerations have driven most teams to stick to the bare minimum; however, a three-Test series is ideal as both teams are in with a shout even if they lose the first match

R. Kaushik  
COLOMBO

Earlier this year, India celebrated the 25th anniversary of one of the most iconic Test series ever, a series like no other. On its own, it was a triumph of extraordinary proportions, but it meant even more from an overarching perspective because of the circumstances under which it was fashioned.

Indian cricket was ensnared in a mesh of shame and lack of trust after the match-fixing scandal broke out in 2000. The average fan had lost faith in their heroes, not knowing what was fact and what was make-believe. Without the patronage of the average fan, of course, no sport can even survive, let alone flourish.

To compound the woes of India's superstars and superstars-in-the-making, they were confronted within a few months of the lid being blown off corruption in the sport by the world's most formidable outfit at the time, a compelling force of the irresistible and the immovable. Steve Waugh's Australians were the gold standard of Test cricket, indeed of any form of cricket, when they arrived in India in early 2001, looking to conquer the Final Frontier that had proved insurmountable for nearly three and a half decades.

Waugh's warriors were sitting on a 15-Test winning streak when the teams lined up at Mumbai's Wankhede Stadium for the first of three matches. Within three days, they had extended their run to a record-equaling (their own record, lest it should be forgotten) 16 matches, blowing Sourav Ganguly's men away with a powerhouse performance with Glenn McGrath, Shane Warne, Matthew Hayden and Adam Gilchrist leading the way.

**The primacy of Test cricket cannot be protected merely by paying lip service; it is incumbent upon every stakeholder involved in this wonderful sport to ensure that the longer version is thriving and vibrant**

That Australian side was as formidable as any Test cricket has witnessed. India, outclassed by 10 wickets, were on a hiding to nothing. Their fans, disillusioned and morose, feared a chastening, humbling, humiliating 3-0 rout, a fear that grew exponentially after India

were shot out for just 171 in the first innings of the next Test at the Eden Gardens in reply to the visitors' 445.

Not even the fact that Harbhajan Singh had become the first Indian to take a Test hat-trick on the opening day of the match provided any solace as India began their second innings, 274 runs in arrears and facing another embarrassing loss. Their three team scores at that point were 176, 219 and 171. Where was the light at the end the tunnel? Did the tunnel even end?

Then began the mother of all fightbacks, a bounce-back of unprecedented magnitude and impact. The decision to thrust V.V.S. Laxman to No. 3 as he swapped places with incumbent Rahul Dravid, who dropped down to No. 6, turned out to be a masterstroke, a call that impacted not just the Test and the series, but also the way teams viewed the follow on and the way teams viewed the Indian side, which now felt that no situation was too daunting, no task was beyond them.

The Hyderabad with the wrists of steel and the Bengalurean with the heart of a champion joined hands in the first of several massive Test associations that would dot their careers. This one was worth 376 - savour that. They batted throughout the fourth day, and when Ganguly applied the closure on the final morning, only one team was in with a winning chance. With Harbhajan continuing his grand form and Sachin Tendulkar atoning for twin knocks of 10 with the scalps of Hayden, Gilchrist and Warne (with a ripping googly, no less),



Miracle men: The Eden Test of 2001 is a classic example of why a three-Test series is a must as India roared back to make it 1-1 and went on to win 2-1. FILE PHOTO: V. V. KRISHNAN

India romped home by the princely margin of 171 runs.

**Dramatic turnaround**

Just 72 hours previously, the dramatic turnaround wasn't even in the realms of fantasy. Through 281 and 180 and the offie's six for 73 and the genius' three for 31, India pulled off a victory for the ages, a result that not just squared the series but also returned the confidence of the fans. Suddenly, cricket and cricketers weren't looked at askance. There was genuine hope and the realisation that this was a bunch of good men in whom faith and trust and belief could be invested without inhibition and doubt.

That was amplified in the next game in Chennai when, in another tight contest, India squeaked home by two wickets to close out a 2-1 victory, one of the most memorable in Test history. Even today, people talk in awe and with reverence of the deeds of Laxman and Dravid, of Tendulkar and Harbhajan, of Ganguly's captaincy, of the spirit and resolve of a bunch of warriors who could so easily have capitulated abjectly after the hammering in the first Test and the meltdown in the first innings of the second, but who refused steadfastly to roll over and who fashioned a miracle of extraordinary proportions.

Now, for a moment, think what it would have been like if it was only a two-Test series, like most are these days unless they involve two of England, Australia and India. Imagine if the series had ended in a 1-1 stalemate after India's epochal comeback at the Eden. If there was no winner only because there wasn't a third match pencilled in. A 1-1 scoreline with one of the Tests drawn is still acceptable but a 1-1 scoreline because a third game is unavailable leaves you with a sense of being deprived of the logical denouement that sport promises. And often delivers.

Think also what it would have been like had India's tour of Sri Lanka in 2015 been a two-Test affair, like it is this time around. At the time, India hadn't won a series in this country since 1993. It was Virat Kohli's first full tour as Test captain in his own right, following the retirement some seven months previously from the five-day game of Mahendra Singh Dhoni. The first Test was in Galle, as it generally is in Sri Lanka, and India ruled the exchanges for three whole days.

Enjoying a first-innings lead of 192, India did allow the hosts to pull away to 367 in their second innings from 95 for five on the back of a special 162 from Dinesh Chandimal, but even then, a fourth-innings target of 176 with more than two days to go was well within the reach of Kohli's lads, among whom were K.L. Rahul, Shikhar Dhawan, Rohit Sharma and Ajinkya Rahane. It seemed as if India had taken it for granted that they would get the job done when they resumed day four on 23 for the loss of Rahul's wicket. The end result - seven wickets for the indefatigable Rangana Herath, a 63-run shock win for the Lankans under Angelo Mathews.

That evening, the Indian dressing room shook with the reverberating aftershocks of the defeat. Harsh words were said, Kohli and then team director Ravi Shastri

read the riot act, and Indian cricket took a massively significant step towards erasing its tag of being lambs overseas. There was a sea change in attitude and team culture, which manifested in convincing victories in the next two games and a fabulous 2-1 triumph that was the genesis of the six-match winning streak on which the team is currently sitting in this nation. Now, what if that had been a two-Test series? How would Indian cricket have shaped up?

"Ideally, I would want a three-Test series," Gautam Gambhir, the India head coach, agreed ahead of the ongoing second Test in Colombo. "I've always believed that there should always be a possibility that a team that loses in the first Test should have the chance to come back. Sometimes, what happens is, in a two-Test match series, if you lose the first Test match, there is no chance for the other team to come back and win the series. The maximum you can do is to try and draw the series.

"I still remember that series, between India and Australia (2001), where India was one down, and they still managed to come back, and win that series 2-1."

Given that the World Test Championship has been in vogue since 2019 and there is no compulsion for teams to play more than two Tests, commercial considerations have driven most teams to stick to the bare minimum. There is a greater demand for T20 Internationals, which is right now the goose that lays the golden eggs, and therefore two-Test showdowns have become the norm. Why, one of the unfounded criticisms against South Africa's march to the WTC final (and eventually the title) last year was that they had shaped their success around two-match faceoffs. That was an unkind cut, because South Africa did what they had to do within the ambit of the rules as they exist. But a greater standardisation of series will help ward off such loose talk, something Arjuna Ranatunga, the legendary Sri Lankan skipper who took the team to the 1996 World Cup crown, strongly espouses.

"For me, playing a Test tournament is not the criterion, it's all about playing bilateral Test matches, playing three- and five-Test series," Ranatunga told this writer a few days back.

"What's this two-Test series about anyway? It's so unfortunate, this World Test Championship is (just) another commercial venture."

Cricket calendars are already packed, with ICC events thrown in every alternate year, be it the T20 World Cup or its 50-over counterpart that still drives the sport despite the dwindling popularity of bilateral ODIs. Then, there are continental events such as the Asia Cup, which also make demands on the Asian Test-playing nations of whom there are five (though only four are involved in the WTC). All of these also contribute a great deal to ensuring that three-Test series become rare as hen's teeth, but as much as the problem might appear insurmountable, there is nothing that will and desire and the urge to put one's money where the mouth is can't achieve.

The primacy of Test cricket cannot be protected merely by paying lip service; it is incumbent upon every stakeholder involved in this wonderful sport to ensure that the longer version is thriving and vibrant, though no one can apportion any blame to the protagonists if they are not as fascinated by the tugs and pulls, the ebbs and flows, of Test cricket, as several others are.

Australia versus Bangladesh is the classic example of the power of the three-match contest. Just imagine the interest levels that would have accompanied the decider after Goliath fought back to quash David's impunity in winning the first Test. Now, we can only think of what might have been. Unfinished business, unfulfilled promise...

## THE GIST

One of the unfounded criticisms against South Africa's march to the WTC final (and eventually the title) last year was that they had shaped their success around two-match faceoffs

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Gambhir has batted for three-Test series. PTI

# Global space norms find a firm footing in India’s new re-entry rules

For many decades, there were few rocket launches and few new satellites in orbit every year, so there were also few re-entries, and most of them simply burned up in the atmosphere with little consequence; but today, low-earth orbit hosts several thousand satellites, with private companies planning for many, many more

Shrawani Shagun

**I**n August 23, India marked its third National Space Day, three years since the Chandrayaan-3 mission’s lunar lander ‘Vikram’ touched down on the moon’s south pole region.

Between then and Hyderabad-based Skyroot Aerospace launching India’s first privately built rocket to orbit, India has come a long way – even as it is also just beginning to regulate the responsibilities that follow from expanding its orbital footprint.

As part of this endeavour, and days after the success of Vikram-1, the Indian National Space Promotion and Authorisation Centre (IN-SPACe) released the country’s first guidelines on planned re-entry.

### A sustainability problem

For many decades, there were few rocket launches and few new satellites in orbit every year, so there were also few re-entries, and most of them simply burned up in the atmosphere with little consequence. But today, low-earth orbit hosts several thousand satellites, with private companies planning for many, many more. Satellite operators are also deliberately bringing satellites down at the end of their operational lives as part of post-mission disposal in great numbers.

A spacecraft returning to the earth has to negotiate many risks, including deviating from its planned path and breaking up into smaller pieces. It may also affect airspace and maritime zones and potentially crash in the territory or jurisdiction of another state.

Here, the idea of sustainability is important. The UN Guidelines for the Long-term Sustainability of Outer Space Activities define ‘sustainability’ as maintaining space activities while preserving the outer space environment for future generations. In this context, re-entry poses a question: how can an increasingly crowded orbital environment remain usable as more objects are launched, operated, and eventually brought back to the earth?

Therefore, re-entry is a physics problem as well as a governance problem. And the new IN-SPACe guidelines are intended to give Indian operators clarity on how the Indian government expects them to solve these problems.

### ‘Conditions of permission’

The guidelines have three important elements.

(i) **Accountability** – Any Indian entity undertaking a planned re-entry, whether within or outside Indian territory, now requires the IN-SPACe’s authorisation. Non-Indian entities seeking to undertake



GSLV Mk-III rocket carries the Crew Module Atmospheric Re-entry Experiment (CARE) on a suborbital flight after lifting off from Sriharikota in 2015. FILE PHOTO

planned re-entry over Indian territory must route the activity through an Indian-incorporated entity, such as a subsidiary, joint venture or partnership, which will be responsible for complying with Indian laws, regulations, and national security requirements.

This has been done because commercialisation creates an accountability gap: i.e. the spacecraft may belong to a private company but the consequences of its return can lie across maritime zones, and jurisdictions. And India has responded by attaching regulatory responsibility to a re-entering entity even before the risk materialises.

Objects designed to survive re-entry or intentionally controlled towards a particular landing or impact area also require separate authorisation. This is what makes a re-entry ‘planned’. On the other hand, objects expected to burn up, melt or fragment sufficiently during natural orbital decay do not count as a planned re-entry.

(ii) **Risk must be acceptable** – The guidelines say the expected casualty risk must remain below 1 in 10,000, supported by survivability and ground-casualty assessments.

As a result, operators have to analyse failure scenarios, fragmentation patterns, ballistic coefficients, de-orbit plans, flight-path angles, and danger zones, and share the results. They must also identify components likely to survive re-entry and hazardous systems such as batteries and pressure vessels.

By requiring quantitative studies and attaching a number to the acceptable risk threshold, the guidelines make sustainability measurable and thus trackable.

(iii) **Permissions** – Per the guidelines, IN-SPACe will re-verify the latest re-entry parameters approximately three months before the proposed operation. If planned re-entry is decided upon after launch, the operator must apply at least six months in advance. Operators must also obtain an IN-SPACe advisory note to issue warnings to airborne and marine vessels in the re-entry area at least 45 days before the re-entry begins.

If a re-entry site falls within the territorial control of a non-Indian state, including in its exclusive economic zones, the applicant must also submit the relevant clearance or authorisation from that state.

These checkpoints ensure that the regulator has fixed windows and mechanisms to intervene when the re-entry parameters change after the mission has launched or the risk pattern has changed for some reason.

### Soft law to domestic rule

For nearly two decades, the international community has developed principles for sustainable space activities. Notable among them are the Inter-Agency Space Debris Coordination Committee’s ‘Space Debris Mitigation Guidelines’ and the ‘Guidelines for the Long-term Sustainability of Outer Space Activities’ of

the U.N. Committee for the Peaceful Uses of Outer Space. Article IX of the Outer Space Treaty 1967 also provides an important foundation for environmental responsibility.

However, most of the contemporary sustainability architecture works on guidelines and other similar forms of ‘soft law’, which operators are not obligated to follow.

The IN-SPACe guidelines solve this problem for India by tying an operator’s fragmentation analysis and insurance policies to the national regulator.

The guidelines also address the financial risks that follow from the Space Liability Convention 1972, which places absolute liability on a launching state for damage caused by its space object on the surface of the earth or to aircraft in flight.

The IN-SPACe guidelines, on the other hand, require operators to undertake planned re-entries at their own risk and say they remain liable for third-party damage and claims. They also indemnify the Government of India and its agencies for liability incurred under India’s international commitments while satisfying the applicable third-party insurance requirements.

Taken together, the IN-SPACe guidelines translate international principles into obligations that private operators in India must satisfy before the government gives them permission to act. (Shrawani Shagun is a researcher focusing on environmental sustainability and space governance. shrawani.shagun@gmail.com)

## THE GIST

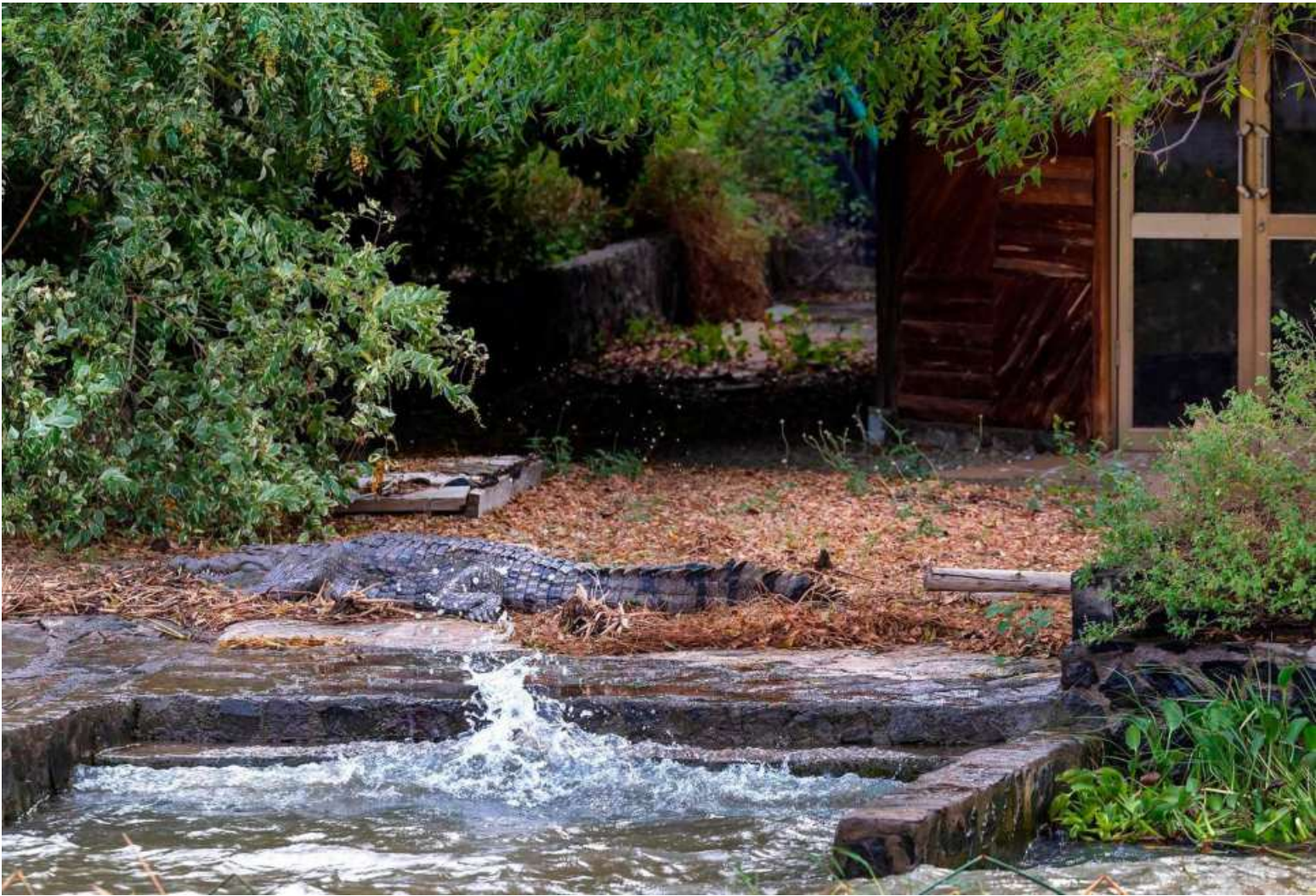
A spacecraft returning to the earth has to navigate several risks. It could affect airspace and maritime zones, or even crash within the territory or jurisdiction of another state. This makes sustainability an important consideration

Days after the success of Vikram-1, IN-SPACe released the country’s first guidelines for planned re-entry

The current international principles for sustainable space activities are soft laws that need not be followed by the operator

The IN-SPACe guidelines solve this problem for India by tying an operator’s fragmentation analysis and insurance policies to the national regulator

## BIG SHOT



A crocodile rests on the edge of a domestic compound now almost completely inundated in the rising waters of the Lake Bogoria in Baringo, Kenya. Lake Baringo and other lakes in Kenya’s Rift Valley have risen to levels not seen in half a century, with scientists attributing the surge to extreme rainfall. AFP

## WHAT IS IT?

# Barren-land fallacy

Vasudevan Mukunth

Trees provide many benefits, including helping cool the neighbourhood, keeping soil from getting eroded, drawing carbon from the environment and storing it, and supporting many birds, small animals, and insects. However, these effects are beneficial only when trees are in the right ecosystem; otherwise, they can be harmful.

The barren-land fallacy is the idea that land that does not have tree cover is barren land, thus ecologically deficient, and that it will ‘evolve’ or should be helped to ‘evolve’ into a forest. The tree-planting drives that happen in India often perpetuate this fallacy by planting trees in the wrong ecosystems. They often also plant trees that are unsuitable for the local conditions, e.g. eucalyptus trees – which draw a lot of water – in a water-stressed area.

Forests are only one kind of ecosystem. Others include grasslands, savannah, scrubland, wetlands, and deserts, plus many naturally open ecosystems. As University of California professor of history and geography Diana Davis has written, “The assumption that the world’s drylands are worthless, deforested, and overgrazed landscapes has led ... to programs and policies that have often systematically damaged dryland environments”.

To ecologically restore a place does not always mean planting more trees.



The Sahel region in Mali is a semi-desert landscape. TIMM GUENTHER (CC BY-SA)

Instead, it is to do whatever will protect or restore the ecosystem that would naturally occur there. In the same vein, planting trees or regenerating forests is only valuable where forests have been degraded or cleared and where a forest is the native ecosystem.

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# Text & Context

THE HINDU

NEWS IN NUMBERS

**Number of drownings recorded by France this summer**

**301** France has recorded over 300 drownings this summer, up sharply from last year, a minister said, linking the surge to the heatwaves that have swept Europe. The 301 drownings are an increase of 14% from the summer of 2025, Sports and Youth Minister Marina Ferrari said. AFP

**Members in election committee for DUSU elections**

**84** The Students' Federation of India has formed an 84-member election committee and launched its "Dream DU of Daflī Gang" to outline the organisation's strategy for the Delhi University Students' Union (DUSU) elections, the student body said on Sunday. PTI

**Stolen two-wheelers recovered by Delhi Police in 4-day drive**

**161** Delhi Police recovered 161 stolen two-wheelers and arrested or apprehended 109 people, including 24 history-sheeters, during a four-day crime-prevention drive in Rohini, officials said on Sunday. The operation was conducted from August 18 to 21. PTI

**Persons arrested by Indonesian police for starting forest fires**

**72** Indonesian authorities arrested 72 people suspected of starting some of the forest and peatland fires as huge blazes in central and west Indonesia triggered choking haze. Indonesia has been battling fires driven by an intensifying El Niño pattern and a prolonged dry season. AP

**E-bus charging points to be established in Himachal Pradesh**

**80** Deputy Chief Minister Mukesh Agnihotri on Sunday said the Himachal Road Transport Corporation is strengthening charging infrastructure for electric buses across the state by establishing charging stations at 80 locations for ₹122 crore. PTI  
COMPILED BY THE HINDU DATA TEAM

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## Vande Mataram and the right to dissent

The 2026 amendment protects *Vande Mataram* from being stopped or disrupted, but does not make singing it compulsory or prescribe all six stanzas; the Supreme Court's *Bijoe Emmanuel* judgment protects an individual's right to remain silent when participation conflicts with freedom of conscience

LETTER & SPIRIT

Haris Beeran

Parliament has given *Vande Mataram* the same criminal-law protection long enjoyed by the national anthem. But a closer look at the Constituent Assembly's own reasoning, the actual text of the new law, and the Supreme Court's judgment in *Bijoe Emmanuel v. State of Kerala* (1986) suggests that the position is far less settled and far more protective of individual conscience than the political rhetoric around the amendment implies.

Why it was not the anthem

The question of India's national anthem was left open for nearly the entire life of the Constituent Assembly. It was finally settled not by a vote, but by a presidential statement on January 24, 1950, at the Assembly's last sitting, when Dr. Rajendra Prasad declared that *Jana Gana Mana* would be the National Anthem of India, and that *Vande Mataram*, "which has played a historic part in the struggle for Indian freedom, shall be honoured equally with *Jana Gana Mana* and shall have equal status with it."

That formula is worth reading carefully, because what it conspicuously does not do is make *Vande Mataram* the anthem or even a co-anthem. The Constitution, when it came into force two days later, contains no reference whatsoever to a "national song". The status of *Vande Mataram* rests entirely on Dr. Prasad's 1950 statement and on subsequent convention, and nothing more.

The reason for this restraint lies earlier, in the Indian National Congress's own reckoning with the song in the 1930s. *Vande Mataram*'s later stanzas, rarely sung today, invoke the motherland in explicitly devotional, goddess-centred terms. In the context of the 1882 novel *Anandamath*, from which the song is drawn, some of its verses were also read as casting Muslims as adversaries. Objections from the Muslim League and others led the Congress Working Committee, in October 1937, to resolve that only the first two stanzas – pastoral, secular in imagery and free of any reference to a deity – would be sung at official gatherings.

That 1937 compromise is what Dr. Prasad's Constituent Assembly statement inherited and preserved in 1950: full-throated reverence for the song's role in the freedom struggle, but a deliberate decision to keep its more contentious, devotional verses out of India's civic and constitutional life. It was not an oversight.

What the amendment says

The Prevention of Insults to National Honour (Amendment) Bill, 2026, was introduced in the Rajya Sabha on July 24, 2026, and cleared both Houses within a week. The Rajya Sabha cleared it on July 29 and the Lok Sabha on July 30, each after only a brief discussion, with the Opposition, including the DMK and Congress, raising strong objections about the Bill being used to advance a particular cultural agenda and about the timing amid unrelated protests in the House. It received Presidential assent shortly after.

Given the speed and thinness of the debate, the Amendment – one of 12 Bills passed in a Monsoon Session in which, by Parliament's own record, most legislation went through with barely any discussion – has had remarkably little parliamentary scrutiny for a law that touches on religious sentiment, free expression and



The law penalises disrespect and disruption of a performance; it does not, on its text, mandate participation in one, nor does it fix which version of the song is entitled to protection. ANI

criminal liability all at once.

What the Amendment actually does is narrower than the headlines suggest. It substitutes Section 3 of the 1971 Act with a provision that punishes two things, and only two things, in relation to both the national anthem and the national song: intentionally preventing their singing and causing disturbance to an assembly engaged in singing them. The punishment – up to three years' imprisonment, a fine, or both, with a mandatory minimum of one year for repeat offenders – is now common to both compositions.

Here is the question mark worth putting squarely to the government: nowhere does the amended Act say which stanzas of *Vande Mataram* must be sung, or that all six stanzas must be sung, for the law's protection to apply. The statute does not prescribe a mandatory version of the song at all. It does not compel singing in the first place by anyone, of any stanza.

All the amended Section 3 requires is that if the national song is being sung, at whatever length and in whatever form, that rendition must not be intentionally prevented or disturbed. That is a materially narrower obligation than the political framing around the Bill – including the government's own push, since late 2025, to popularise and even mandate all six stanzas at official functions – might lead the public to believe. The law penalises disrespect and disruption of a performance; it does not, on its text, mandate participation in one, nor does it fix which version of the song is entitled to protection.

The later stanzas

The commonly sung opening stanzas of *Vande Mataram* describe the motherland in pastoral terms, her waters, her fruit, her cooling breezes, her fields. It is the later stanzas, historically dropped from public renditions by the Congress in 1937 but increasingly promoted for full recitation since the government's commemoration of the song's 150th anniversary in late 2025, that shift register entirely.

In substance, and in every available English rendering, they describe the motherland as embodied in the Hindu goddesses Durga, Lakshmi and Saraswati, respectively, goddesses of power, wealth and learning, and speak of her as an object of worship enshrined in temples, with "crores" of arms raised in her

defence. This is not patriotic verse loosely coloured with cultural reference; on a plain reading, it is a devotional address to a deity, structured in the grammar of prayer.

Freedom of conscience

India is constitutionally committed to a plurality of faiths: Hindu, Muslim, Christian, Sikh, Buddhist, Jain, Parsi and others, each entitled under Article 25 to freedom of conscience and the free profession, practice and propagation of religion, and under Article 26 to manage its own religious affairs without State interference.

For adherents of monotheistic faiths in particular, being required, whether by direct compulsion or by the coercive pressure of a criminal statute looming over any public assembly, to stand through or refrain from disrupting an extended recitation addressed to Hindu goddesses raises a genuine and serious constitutional difficulty. A citizen's discomfort with participating in what is, on the text, an act of worship of deities outside their own faith is not eccentric; it is exactly the kind of conscientious objection that Articles 25 and 26 exist to protect.

Articles 25 and 26 are fundamental rights. It is a basic proposition of Indian constitutional law that no ordinary legislation, however patriotically framed or however overwhelming its parliamentary majority, can override a fundamental right. A law that has the effect of pressuring citizens, on pain of criminal liability for anyone thought to be "disturbing" its recitation, to acquiesce in a devotional performance contrary to their faith would not survive that Part III scrutiny. The 2026 Amendment does not, fortunately, go that far on its text, but the danger, as the next section shows, lies in how it may be applied.

The Bijoe Emmanuel ruling

This is not an abstract or first-time question for Indian courts. It was addressed directly and decisively in *Bijoe Emmanuel & Ors. v. State of Kerala* (1986), a case that remains the single most important precedent on the collision between compelled patriotic ritual and freedom of conscience.

Three siblings, Bijoe, Binu Mol and Bindu Emmanuel, practising Jehovah's Witnesses, stood respectfully and silently while their schoolmates sang *Jana Gana*

*Mana* during morning assembly. They did not sing themselves because their faith forbade what they understood as an act of worship of anyone or anything other than god. For this, they were expelled.

The Kerala High Court upheld the expulsion, holding that Article 51A's fundamental duty to respect the national anthem overrode any claim under Articles 25 and 26, and that Jehovah's Witnesses could not even invoke those protections.

The Supreme Court, in a judgment authored by Justice O. Chinnappa Reddy, reversed the High Court in emphatic terms. The Bench held that compelling a person to join in singing despite a genuine, conscientiously held religious objection contravenes both Article 19(1)(a) – freedom of expression, which the court held extends to the freedom to remain silent – and Article 25(1), the guarantee of freedom of conscience.

Crucially, the court held that the fundamental duties enumerated under Article 51A cannot be used to cut down or override the fundamental rights guaranteed under Part III of the Constitution; a duty to respect national symbols cannot, in law, be turned into a licence to punish sincere religious dissent. The court also read the 1971 Act itself as requiring nothing more than respectful conduct, not active participation from anyone present. It closed with the observation that the country's tradition, philosophy and Constitution alike "practise tolerance," urging that this not be diluted.

That ruling has never been overturned, and its logic transfers with full force to *Vande Mataram*, arguably with greater force, given that the song's later verses are, unlike the anthem, addressed to specific deities. If the Supreme Court held that a Jehovah's Witness could not be compelled to sing a secular anthem against conscience, the same protection must extend, a fortiori, to a citizen who objects to reciting verses that are, on their face, prayers to Hindu goddesses.

Legal position

Put together, the three strands here point to a single, clear conclusion.

First, the Constituent Assembly and the country's founding leadership deliberately confined official recognition to the first two, secular stanzas of *Vande Mataram*. That is precisely why the fuller, devotional version was never made compulsory, then or since.

Second, the 2026 Amendment, whatever its political framing, imposes no textual obligation on any citizen to sing any particular version of the song, let alone all six stanzas. It penalises only the prevention or disturbance of a singing that is already taking place.

Third, and most importantly, even where the song, including its later stanzas, is sung, a citizen who chooses not to join in because doing so would offend their freedom of conscience under Article 25 is under no legal obligation to participate.

The law as laid down by the Supreme Court in *Bijoe Emmanuel* gives that citizen complete protection: standing respectfully, in silence, without disrupting others, is not an offence under this Act, was not an offence under the original 1971 Act, and cannot be made one merely by extending the statute to a new composition.

Citizens uneasy about the fuller version of *Vande Mataram* do not need to wait for a court to vindicate them after the fact. The law, correctly read, already protects them. (Haris Beeran is a Rajya Sabha MP and a lawyer)

THE GIST

▼ *Vande Mataram* was given equal status with *Jana Gana Mana* in 1950 for its historic role in the freedom struggle, but was never made the national anthem or a co-anthem.

▼ The 1937 Congress compromise limited official renditions to the first two stanzas, keeping the later devotional verses invoking Hindu goddesses out of civic and official life.

▼ The 2026 amendment has renewed debate over the song's later stanzas and the constitutional questions surrounding religious freedom, freedom of conscience and the State's role in patriotic expression.

